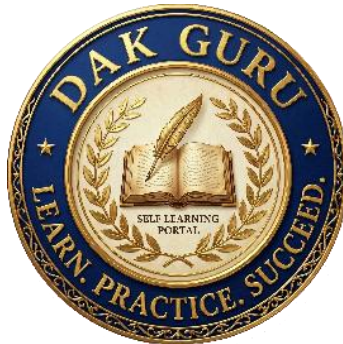




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THE POST OFFICE REGULATIONS, 2024

A Study Booklet for LDCE IP & PS Group 'B' Examinations

Chapter-wise notes · tariff tables · premium products · exam cheat-sheet

Parent Act	Post Office Act, 2023 (Act No. 43 of 2023)
Principal Notification	S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024
Structure	15 Chapters · 180 Regulations · 5 Schedules
Currency	Amendments in force up to 1 August 2026 (Fifth & Sixth Amendments, 2026)
Compiled	August 2026

Verified against the Gazette of India and Directorate orders. Statutory rates are exclusive of GST.

Disclaimer

This booklet is a study aid prepared by Dak Guru to help candidates preparing for the Departmental Examinations of the Department of Posts (LDCE Inspector Posts and PS Group 'B'). It is intended purely for educational and reference purposes.

It is NOT a substitute for the official text. The Post Office Regulations, 2024, their amendments, the Post Office Act, 2023, and all Directorate circulars, gazette notifications and Standard Operating Procedures referred to here are the sole authentic sources. In case of any conflict, the official Gazette of India and departmental orders shall prevail.

Every figure and provision has been cross-checked against primary sources current to 13 August 2026, and the latest incorporated amendment is the Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (S.O. 4241(E) dated 31.07.2026, in force 01.08.2026). Where a source could not be confirmed to primary level, the point is expressly flagged (△) in the text. Tariffs, limits and procedures change frequently; readers must re-verify against the current gazette before relying on any figure.

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THE POST OFFICE REGULATIONS, 2024

The **Post Office Regulations, 2024** were notified vide Notification No. S.O. 5440(E) dated **16th December, 2024**, exercising powers under **Section 13** of the **Post Office Act, 2023**. These regulations supersede previous rules where applicable.

Currency of these notes. Updated to **13 August 2026**. Principal regulations: **S.O. 5440(E) dated 16.12.2024** (in force 16.12.2024; 180 regulations, 15 chapters, 5 Schedules). Key amendments incorporated:

- **Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025** — in force **01.10.2025**: revised the Speed Post (Document) tariff [reg 98(2)]; inserted a new definition in reg 2; omitted reg 132.
- **Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2025** — notified 30.12.2025, in force **01.01.2026**: omitted “small packets” from regs 22 / 107 / 112 / 128 / 138 / 143 and from Schedules III & IV; reg 107 “parcel post” now includes international air parcels. *(Primary text not in hand — flagged in Chapter VI.)*
- **Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026** — S.O. 1329(E): introduced **24 Speed Post & 48 Speed Post** (reg 99A); products launched **17.03.2026**.
- **Post Office (Fifth Amendment) Regulations, 2026** — S.O. 4053(E) dated **23.07.2026**, in force **01.08.2026**: substituted the *document* definition (reg 98, Notes 1 & 2); revised 24 / 48 Speed Post tariffs (reg 99A(5); Tables IV B, IV C, IV E, IV F).
- **Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2026** — S.O. 4241(E) dated **31.07.2026**, in force **01.08.2026**: inserted **reg 96A** (India Post Parcel Last Mile) + Table III A; revised India Post Parcel (Table III) and Speed Post Parcel (Table IV) tariffs to a zone structure.
- **Parcel Directorate clarification No. 39-09/2025-PD dated 05.08.2026** — zone / metro categorisation for the revised parcel tariffs.

As on the date of compilation, the **Sixth Amendment, 2026** is the latest traced amendment; Every statutory figure herein is drawn from the corresponding gazette; where a source could not be confirmed to primary level it is expressly flagged.

CHAPTER I

PRELIMINARY

1. Short title and commencement.

- (1) These regulations may be called the Post Office Regulations, 2024.
- (2) They shall come in to force on the 16th day of December, 2024.

2. Definitions.

- (1) In these regulations, unless the context otherwise requires, -
 - (a) "accountable items" means such items that provide a receipt at the time of booking for track and trace (stage wise electronic data on movement of item) and require the signature (in ink or digital) of the addressee, the payee, or their authorised person upon receipt of an item, to provide evidence of delivery and include items such as India Post Parcel, Speed Post, Magazine Post, International Speed Post Services (EMS), International Air Parcels, International Tracked Packets, International Registered Letter items, Money Order and items with value added services like registration, insurance and cash on delivery (COD);
 - (b) "Act" means the Post Office Act, 2023 (43 of 2023);
 - (c) "addressee" means the intended recipient or the person to whom any item is to be delivered;
 - (d) "administrative instructions" means the executive or administrative orders or instructions including guidelines issued by the Central Government or, as the case may be, the Director General as specified under regulation 178 or regulation 179 or regulation 180, as the case may be;
 - (e) "authorised person" means a person, duly authorised by the addressee to receive the item or by a payee to receive the money on his behalf;
 - (f) "delivery" means the delivery of an item at the address of the addressee, or to the addressee or other person or location considered to be authorised to receive the item according to the usual manner of delivering items to the addressee;
 - (g) "Director (Postal Services)" means the Director in any administrative office of the Post Office or an officer exercising the powers of Director (Postal Services);

- (h) "in course of transmission by post" means the period starting from receipt of an item by the post office to its delivery to the addressee or return to the sender or otherwise disposed of;
- (i) "letter box" means a box installed in post offices or mail offices or at public places, for posting of fully prepaid letters, postcards, letter cards and book post items;
- (j) "payee" means the person who intends to receive money through money remittance services;
- (k) "post" means any system for collection, clearance, sorting, dispatch, conveyance, and delivery of items by the postal network;
- (l) "Postmaster" means the Director or Chief Postmaster of general post office, or Senior Postmaster or Head Postmaster of head post office, or an officer exercising the powers of Postmaster, as the case may be, who is the head of such post office;
- (m) "redirection" means action of assigning or directing an item to an address, other than the one to which it was initially addressed, for a specific reason;
- (n) "remitter" means the person who remits money through money remittance services;
- (o) "rules" means the Post Office Rules, 2024 and the expression "rule" shall mean a rule of the said rules;
- (p) "schedule" means the schedule annexed to these regulations;
- (q) "sender" means a person who sends any item; and
- (r) "weight" means gross weight or volumetric weight, whichever is higher, except when stated otherwise.

CHAPTER II

GENERAL

3. Business hours.

(1) The business hours in a post office, during which business is transacted with the public, shall generally be as under on normal weekdays, which are not holidays for the Post Office or the Government holidays, namely: -

Sl. No.	Work	Business Hours
(i)	For references and enquiries	During the entire working hours of the office
(ii)	Counter services including booking and posting of items, premium collection of insurance premiums	Six hours
(iii)	Money remittance- Electronic Money Order, Indian Postal Order etc.	Six hours
(iv)	Savings Bank	Six hours

(2) Branch post offices shall be kept open for a maximum period of **five hours** in a day.

4. (1) The Circle Head, Regional Head and Divisional Head are empowered to specify the period of each of the post offices under their jurisdiction, during which business is transacted with the public or customer and the time at which items are delivered and dispatched, keeping in view, the maximum working hours, business hours, local convenience and the arrival and departure timings of the items and working of the post office counters.

(2) The Circle Head or Regional Head may, if it is necessary or expedient to meet the requirement of the public, or in any special circumstances, specify-

(a) the business hours and the days other than the working days including Sundays and holidays, during which the post offices shall be opened for business;

(b) the kind of transactions available during such business hours; and

(c) the maximum number of items that may be tendered for booking during business hours to meet the rush of work in a post office and to ensure the equitable availability of facilities to the public.

5. Payment of postage and other sums chargeable on items.

(1) Postage shall generally be paid by modes mentioned in rule 9.

(2) The pre-payment of postage and other sums payable on an item shall be mandatory except otherwise mentioned in these regulations.

6. Postage on unaccountable items and unpaid items.

(1) If the postage required on unaccountable items, which have embossed postage on it, is more than the value of the stamp printed on them, the difference shall be made good by affixing additional postage stamps of the requisite value.

(2) Unpaid or insufficiently paid items are liable to be kept on hold for charging the postage due on them.

7. Postage and chargeable sums not deemed to be prepaid.

The postage and other sums chargeable on an item shall not be deemed to be prepaid by means of a proper stamp or franking impression or point of sale receipt if-

(a) the stamp or impression of a stamp or impression which has not been provided for use as a postage stamp or franking impression or point of sale receipt under these regulations or rules;

(b) the stamp has been obliterated, defaced, torn, cut or otherwise rendered imperfect;

(c) the stamp or franking impression or point of sale receipt has upon it, any word, letter, figure or design, printed or impressed upon it, otherwise than by the Director General before posting; or

(d) the stamp has been cut, or otherwise, separated from an embossed envelope, or from a postcard or wrapper:

Provided that nothing in this regulation shall prevent the perforation of postage stamps with initials, or other identifying marks, traced in minute holes:

Provided further that nothing in this regulation shall prevent the transmission of Book Now Pay Later (BNPL) items or other items as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

8. Supply of postage stamps.

(1) The operational guidelines for supply, custody and sale of postage stamps, shall be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) No person or entity or institution or organisation or electronic platform shall sell or distribute postage stamps or deal in any other manner in postage stamps, except with the prior permission of the Director General.

(3) Whoever contravenes the provisions of sub-regulation (2) above or any term or condition of permission issued thereunder shall be punishable under the relevant provisions of the applicable law of the land for the time being in force.

9. Fraudulent usage of stamp.

(1) The act of usage of previously used postage stamp, fraudulently or with intent to cause loss to the Government, shall be punishable under the applicable law of the land for the time being in force.

(2) If such postage stamp is detected on an item already posted, the item shall not be delivered and dealt with in a manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

10. Illegal manufacture or usage of postage stamps.

(1) The illegal manufacturing and usage of the postage stamp such as forged, counterfeit, or fictitious postage stamps shall be punishable under the applicable law of the land for the time being in force.

(2) Reproduction of stamps shall only be allowed for illustration purposes in a philatelic publication, or in an item or section relating wholly to postage stamps that may appear in a publication or a general character, and such reproductions shall only be in such form as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

11. Philately.

(1) Philately is a study and collection of stamps, postal stationery, postmarks and other philatelic materials.

(2) The operational procedures related with the philately shall be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

12. Philatelic materials.

(1) Philatelic materials shall be issued by the Post Office as per administrative instructions specified from time to time.

(2) Philatelic materials include

(a) philatelic stamps;

(b) first day covers, brochures or information sheets, special covers, maxim cards, annual packs, postal stationeries and various Philatelic publications and ancillaries;

(c) artworks, proofs, progressive sheets, printed sheets and printing plates of philatelic stamps; and

(d) postmarks, slogan dies and other artifacts used in connection with the production of philatelic stamps.

(3) The Director General shall specify by administrative instructions the philatelic material to be sold in post offices.

(4) All the activities corresponding to production and issue of philatelic materials shall be carried out as per administrative instructions issued from time to time.

13. Issuance of postage stamps.

The postage stamps shall be issued in the following types, namely:-

(a) **Definitive Stamps:** Definitive Stamps are postage stamps, specifically issued to meet the day-to-day postage needs and are made available for sale for a period till stocks of a particular series last, which shall be printed and reprinted in different denominations as per the requirement of the post office.

(b) **Commemorative Stamps:**

(i) Commemorative Stamps are postage stamps issued to commemorate an event, institution, theme and personages, which shall be printed only once, in limited numbers and are sold for a limited period, as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time, through philatelic bureaus, philatelic counters, online channels or authorised offices.

(ii) The Commemorative Stamps may be kept as collectible items and may be used for payment of postage.

(c) **Special Stamps:** Special Stamps are postage stamps which are thematic like flora, fauna, architecture or art without commemorating any specific event.

(d) **Joint Issue Stamps:** Joint Issue Stamps are postage stamps which are issued by India and any other country on mutually agreed terms and conditions.

(e) **My Stamps:** My Stamps are such stamps which are issued on the basis of personalised or customised printing elements provided by the customer or proponent, subject to confirmation with administrative instructions specified from time to time.

14. (1) Issuance of Commemorative Postage Stamp. Any citizen of India may tender a proposal for issue of Commemorative Postage Stamp in accordance with the administrative instructions specified from time to time.

- (2) All such proposals shall be examined on the basis of the administrative instructions specified by the Central Government from time to time.
- (3) Proponents for issue of a commemorative stamp relating to institutions or events or organisations are required to make a mandatory purchase of number of such stamps as specified by administrative instructions from time to time: Provided that in exceptional and deserving cases, Central Government may relax this condition.
- (4) The denominations of postage stamps shall be in consonance with domestic and international postal postage.
- (5) No postage stamp shall be issued on a living personality.
- (6) Stamp design and denomination shall be as approved by the Central Government.
- (7) All philatelic stamps, brochures, first day covers and philatelic ancillaries shall be sold by the Post Office on the denoted value or on the value specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

15. Philatelic Advisory Committee.

- (1) The Philatelic Advisory Committee shall advise on the issue of Commemorative Stamps, Special Stamps, and other allied matters related thereto.
- (2) The Union Minister-in-Charge of the Ministry of Communications shall be the ex officio Chairperson of the Philatelic Advisory Committee and shall nominate the official and non-official members of the Committee as per the administrative instructions specified from time to time.

16. Manner of affixing postage stamps.

- (1) Stamps affixed to an item must be completely adherent to the item itself and not to any part of its contents or any separate label or other device tied or attached to the item.
- (2) The stamps should be affixed to the right-hand top corner of the address side.
- (3) The provisions of this regulation shall apply to franking of items in toto.

17. Price of postage stamps and stationery.

- (1) Postage stamps, postcards, letter card and aerogramme shall be sold for the denoted value of the stamps which they bear.
- (2) The embossed envelopes and the registration envelopes shall be sold at the prices mentioned in Table VII of Schedule I.

(3) Special Rakhi Envelopes shall be sold at the prices as the Circle Head concerned may determine.

18. Standards for addressing on domestic items.

(1) An item shall not have more than one delivery address;

Provided that nothing in this sub-regulation shall prevent the delivery of an item to another address as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) The address, either handwritten or machine printed, shall contain such elements and, in such order, as given below: -

Order of address elements — domestic items

#	Address line (in order)
1	Name — C/o, D/o, S/o, W/o, H/o · Mobile Number (optional) · House / Building (incl. floor) / Apartment (incl. floor)
2	Street / Road / Lane / Landmark
3	Area / Locality / Sector · Village / Town / City
4	Post Office · District · State
5	PIN code / Postcode

(3) The address of the addressee shall be written in the centre of the front side and address of the sender shall be written on the lower left of the front side of an envelope.

(4) Address of the addressee and the sender should be started from the words "To" and "From", respectively.

(5) Blank space of minimum 15mm shall be kept from left, bottom and right side of envelope and the address block of addressee shall have minimum gap of 40 mm from top.

(6) Stamps or Frank impressions shall be affixed in maximum area of 74 mm on the upper right corner.

(7) The address of addressee and sender should be positioned parallel to the length of the envelope.

(8) A zone of 10mm around the address block should be free from any printing or writing.

(9) Non-address information such as sender's code, serial or account numbers or other information are not to be generally included in the address of the addressee and if necessary, it should be printed above the first line but never below the last line of the address.

(10) The spacing between the address lines shall be uniform and be more than 1mm and less than 5mm.

(11) The maximum number of characters per line is 40 characters, excluding spaces between words.

(12) An accountable item tendered at a post office for transmission shall not be accepted unless they are addressed to a particular person or firm or institution.

(13) Such items addressed to a particular person or firm, care of post box and the name of the office where the post box is located shall also be accepted, provided they are addressed to persons or firms in whose names the post box stands registered;

Provided that in the office of delivery, if it is found that there is no post box in the name of the addressee, or the addressee has ceased to be a renter of a post box, the item shall be returned to the sender.

19. Mails for defence services personnel.

The following particulars shall be furnished in the address in the case of items for the personnel of the defence services, which are to be delivered through the army post offices: -

Address format — defence services: No. · Rank · Name · Unit

- Such items should be addressed to Care of (C/o) **56 A.P.O.** or Care of (C/o) **99 A.P.O.**

20. Exemption in method of addressing of an item in certain cases.

"Any item, addressed to the CVC as well as CVOs, posted with the superscription 'Complaint under the Public Interest Disclosure' or 'PIDPI Complaint' on the outside of the envelope of the item, may be accepted for transmission by post, without the name and complete address of the sender.

Note: "PIDPI" shall be entered against the name and address field of the sender at the time of booking of items through the software (system).

21. Standards for addressing on international items.

(1) An item shall not have more than one delivery address:

Provided that nothing in this sub-regulation shall prevent the delivery of an item to another address as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) The address, either handwritten or machine printed, shall be worded in a precise, complete and legible manner to ensure the easy transmission of the item and its delivery at the country or territory of destination to the addressee.

(3) The address of the sender and the addressee must be written in roman letters and in Arabic numerals, and wherever required, the address of the addressee may also be written in the language of country or territory of destination.

(4) The name of the place of destination and the country or territory of destination shall be written in capital letters together with the correct postcode number or delivery zone number, whichever applicable.

(5) The address of the sender and addressee shall contain such elements, whichever applicable, and, in such order, as given below, unless otherwise specified: -

Order of address elements — international items

#	Address line (in order)
1	Name — Mobile Number (optional) · Building (door, floor, stairwell, wing, distinct instances) · Street (name / number / type, primary & secondary thoroughfare) · PO Box
2	Post Office — City / town / Rural Area · Administrative Areas (region level)
3	Postcode · Country / Territory

(6) The address of the addressee shall be written on right of front side and address of the sender shall be written on lower left of front side on an envelope.

(7) The address of the addressee and the sender should be started from the words "To" and "From", respectively.

(8) Blank space of minimum 15mm shall be kept from left, bottom and right side of envelope and the address block of addressee shall have minimum gap of 40 mm from top.

Stamps or Frank impressions shall be affixed in maximum area of 74 mm on the upper right corner.

(9) A zone of 10mm around the address block should be free from any printing or writing.

(10) Non-address information such as sender's code, serial or account numbers or other information are not to be generally included in the address of the addressee and if necessary, it should be printed above the first line but never below the last line of the address.

(11) The spacing between the address lines shall be uniform and be more than 1mm and less than 5mm.

(12) The maximum number of characters per line is 40 characters, excluding spaces between words.

(13) An accountable item tendered at a post office for transmission shall not be accepted unless they are addressed as per regulations 18, 19 and sub-regulation (5).

22. Posting of items.

The following modes may be used for posting of items: -

(a) Letter Boxes - Letters, letter cards, aerogramme, postcards, airmail postcards, book post, small packets, printed papers and literature for the blind, shall be posted in the letter boxes, provided the postage chargeable is fully prepaid.

- **Note 1:** Registered newspaper items, periodical post items and franked items shall not be posted in these letter boxes and, if posted, these shall be treated as unpaid and shall be dealt as per **regulation 71**.
- **Note 2:** Accountable items shall also not be posted in the letter boxes.
- **Note 3:** Large items, which owing to their size cannot be posted in the letter-boxes, may be received by hand at the window of the post office. However, such items shall not be deemed to be accountable items.

(b) Post office counter - All the accountable items shall be presented at the counter of post office for transmission by post.

(c) Franchisee Outlet - Items as specified by administrative instructions from time to time, may be presented through the franchisee outlet of the Post Office.

(d) Self-Booking Kiosk - Self-booking kiosk available at the designated post offices may be used for posting of items as may be specified by administrative instructions.

- *Note: The Regional Head is authorised to designate the post offices, where the service of self-booking kiosk is available.*

(e) **Web or Mobile Application** - The authorised web portal or mobile application may be used for posting of items as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

23. Receipt for transmission by post.

A receipt shall be given to the person who presents an accountable item for transmission by post.

24. Ownership of items.

(1) For domestic items, an item shall remain the property of the sender until it is delivered to the rightful addressee, except in the case of seizure of the item under the applicable law of the land for the time being in force.

(2) For international items, an item shall remain the property of the sender until it is delivered to the rightful addressee, except in the case of seizure of the item under any law of the land of the country or territory of origin or transit or destination.

25. Prohibition of domestic items.

(1) Subject to the provisions of these regulations, no person shall send by post, -

(a) any explosive, dangerous, filthy, noxious or deleterious substance, any sharp instrument not properly protected, or any living creature which is either noxious or likely to injure items in course of transmission by post or any officer of the Post Office; or

(b) anything likely to injure, any item during transmission by post, or any officer of the Post Office; or

(c) any ticket, proposal, advertisement or any other matter relating to a lottery, except the case where the lottery is organised or authorised by the Central Government or State Government; or

(d) any indecent, immoral or obscene printing, painting, photograph, lithograph, engraving, book or card, or any other digital media, or any other indecent, immoral, or obscene item; or

(e) any item having thereon, or on the cover thereof, any words, marks or designs of an indecent, obscene, seditious, scurrilous, threatening or grossly offensive character; or

(f) any item having thereon, or on the cover thereof, any matter which is prejudicial to the maintenance of law and order; or

(g) any item having thereon, or on the cover thereof, any pictorial representation of a person who is a proclaimed offender, or who has been convicted of an offence punishable under any applicable law of the land for the time being in force; or

(h) any item having thereon, or on the cover thereof, anything written, printed, or otherwise impressed upon or attached to its address side, which, either on account of its being likely to be mistaken for stamps used for the payment of postage or by inconvenient proximity to any such stamp or by tending to prevent the easy and quick reading of the address; or

(i) narcotics and psychotropic substances, as defined by the International Narcotics Control Board, or other illicit drugs which are prohibited in the country or territory of destination, the country or territory of origin, the Central Government, State Governments, or any authorised agency; or

(j) counterfeit and pirated items; or

(k) anything which, by their nature or their packing, may expose officials or the general public to danger, or soil or damage other items, postal equipment, or third party property; or

(l) dangerous goods, narcotics and psychotropic substances, prohibited drugs and cosmetics items, items prohibited by or under International Air Transport Association (IATA), International Civil Aviation Organisation (ICAO), Department of Wildlife and the Drug and Cosmetics Act, 1940 (23 of 1940) or items prohibited by any law of the land; or

- **Explanation.-** For the purpose of this clause, "dangerous goods" means items or substances that are capable of posing a risk to health, safety, property or environment, which include explosives, gases, flammable liquids, toxic and infectious substances, corrosives and other miscellaneous items which may cause health and safety hazards:
- Provided that battery and other items, the transmission of which, by air, is prohibited, shall be sent to the addressee through surface mode only; or

(m) live animals except otherwise permitted in these regulations; or

(n) coins, banknotes and other valuable items, except permitted through a special process:

Provided that the order shall be in consonance with Reserve Bank of India guidelines, Foreign Exchange Management (Export and Import of Currency) Regulations, 2015 made under the Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999 (42 of 1999), or any other applicable law of the land for the time being in force on the subject:

Provided further that currency notes, coins, or bank notes, shall invariably be transmitted as insured items; or

(o) other items, the importation or circulation of which is prohibited in the country or territory of origin or destination; or

(p) documents having the character of current and personal correspondence, with the exception of archived materials, exchanged between persons other than the sender and the addressee or persons living with them; or

(q) anything prohibited in International Postal Services by the Universal Postal Union (UPU) or any other organisation; or

(r) any other thing, prohibited by Central Government from time to time.

26. Prohibition of international items.

International items not fulfilling the conditions laid down in these regulations shall not be admitted and items sent in furtherance of a fraudulent act or with the intention of avoiding payment of the postage or other postal fee, shall not be admitted.

27. Application of regulation 25 on international items.

Regulation 25 shall apply to International items to be transmitted by post to or from any foreign country or territory, except in the following cases, namely: -

(a) such dangerous goods which may be transmitted by post between the country or territory of origin and destination that have declared their willingness to admit them either reciprocally or in one direction, provided that they comply with national and international relevant laws;

(b) live animals which shall be admitted in-

(i) letter post items other than insured items: bees, leeches and silk-worms; parasites and destroyers of noxious insects intended for the control of those insects and exchanged between officially recognised institutions; flies of the family Drosophilidae for biomedical research exchanged between officially recognised institutions;

(ii) parcels: live animals whose conveyance by post is authorised by the postal regulations or applicable laws of the countries or territories concerned.

28. Transmission of precious metals and precious stones.

(1) Precious metals (including gold, silver, platinum or other precious metals), precious stones (including diamond or other precious stones), jewellery or any combination of these, whether manufactured or not, coins, bank notes, currency notes, securities of any kind payable to bearer, travellers' cheques, except as otherwise specified, shall, in no case, be transmitted by post in an uninsured letter-post item.

(2) Without prejudice to the provisions of sub-rule (1), any country or territory may prohibit the enclosure of gold bullion in insured or uninsured parcels originating from or addressed to its territory or sent in transit à découvert (open transit) across its territory; to the actual value of the items so transmitted.

29. Items for blind prohibited in certain cases.

The items shall be prohibited from being transmitted as printed papers and literature for the blind under the following conditions, namely:-

(a) shall not bear any inscription or contain any item of correspondence;

(b) shall not contain any postage stamp or form of prepayment, whether cancelled or not, or any paper representing a monetary value, except in cases where the item contains as an enclosure, a card, envelope or wrapper, bearing the printed address of the sender of the item or his authorised person in the country or territory of posting or destination of the original item, which is prepaid for return.

30. Items transmitted in contravention of regulation 27.

(1) An item in contravention of regulation 27 shall, in no circumstances, be forwarded to their destination, delivered to the addressees, or returned to origin whichever is applicable.

(2) Where, any item referred to in sub-regulation (1) is discovered during transit, it shall be handled under the applicable law of the country or territory of transit.

(3) Where, any item referred to in sub-regulation (1) is discovered during transmission, it shall be liable to be removed and disposed of in the manner as may be specified by administrative instructions and the remainder of the items shall be forwarded to its destination, together with information about the disposal of such inadmissible item.

31. Customs Control.

(1) All international outbound items tendered at the post office shall be subject to customs control and the applicable laws of the country or territory of origin and the country or territory of destination.

(2) All international inward items shall be subject to customs' control and the applicable law of the land for the time being in force.

(3) Any custom duty imposed by the customs department, along with an additional postal fee as mentioned as under, shall be charged from the addressee at the time of delivery.

CUSTOM CLEARANCE

For clearance through the Customs, a fee, recoverable from the addressee, at the following rate if released after levying customs duty

(a) for each foreign letter packet or insured box; and

(b) for each foreign parcel or bulk bag of printed matter which weighs more than 500 grams,
Rupees thirty

32. Post Office authorised to collect customs duty, etc.

The Post Office shall be authorised to collect from the sender or addressee of items, as the case may be, the customs duty and all other fees which may be due.

33. Items sent in contravention of any law.

Any item sent by post in contravention of any Act, rules, regulations, or any other law of the land for the time being in force, may be detained and disposed of in the manner as directed by the enforcement agency or authority or officer, as the case may be.

34. Disposal of intercepted items.

(1) If an official or officer of the Post Office suspects on reasonable grounds that an item in the course of its transmission

(a) contains anything in respect of which an offence is being committed or an attempt to commit an offence is being made; or

(b) contains anything that will afford evidence of the commission of an offence; or

(c) is being sent to further the commission of an offence; or

(d) needs to be obtained and examined in the interests of defence, public safety or public order,

Such official or officer shall inform the competent authority for directions to detain the item for the purpose of examination by the concerned law enforcement authority in accordance with the provisions of the rules.

(2) If, on examination of an item under sub-regulation (1), the suspicion that gave rise to its examination-

(a) is substantiated, the item may be detained for the purposes of evidence in a criminal prosecution or destroyed or dealt with in such other manner as may be authorised in the orders of the law enforcement authorities;

(b) is not substantiated, the item shall be delivered to the person to whom it is addressed or to the authorised person.

35. Items suspected to contain dangerous substances.

(1) Where an item is suspected to contain any explosive, dangerous, obnoxious, deleterious or filthy substance, or anything likely to injure the mails or any officer of the Post Office, it shall be intercepted and detained at the point of transmission, where it is so detected and the officer-in-charge of the post office shall immediately inform the matter to the police authorities, post office authorities and other designated authorities, as may be applicable.

(2) Further necessary action in respect of the item, shall be taken in accordance with the directions of the authorities as referred in sub-regulation (1).

36. Restriction on disclosure.

No person may disclose any communication or information, which is obtained in the exercise of his powers or the performance of his duties in terms of these regulations, except-

- (a) to any other person, who of necessity requires it for the like exercise or performance of their functions in terms of these regulations;
- (b) information which is required to be disclosed in terms of any law or as evidence in any court of law.

37. Disposal of items opened.

- (1) If any item opened or examined by designated postal officer under the rules is found to be an unlawful item or prohibited item, the items shall be disposed of in accordance with the directions of the designated authorities.
- (2) If the item referred to in sub-regulation (1) is found not to be an unlawful or prohibited one, it shall be forwarded to its destination as if it had not been so opened or examined.

38. Notice of opening of an item.

Where an item that is found to be unlawful, is opened by a postal officer or official under **section 9** of the Act, a notice shall be sent to the sender, and if not found, to the addressee.

39. No relief from liability.

The detention, opening, examination, destruction or disposal of an item under the Act or rules or these regulations shall not relieve any person from the liability for any offence against these regulations.

40. No right to compensation.

No person shall have any right to compensation, nor shall any liability be incurred by the Department of Posts in the Ministry of Communications or any of its officers or officials, by the reason of the detention, opening, examination, forfeiture, destruction or disposal of an item or its enclosure, under the powers conferred by the Act or rules or regulations or the applicable law of the land for the time being in force.

CHAPTER III

MANNER OF DELIVERY OF ITEMS

41. Accountable items.

The delivery of the accountable items shall be made-

- (a) to the addressee or the authorized person in case of registered item, insured item, Cash on Delivery, Money order;
- (b) to the authorised person or on the address in case of speed post item, India post parcel, etc.

42. Accountable items to be issued for delivery.

- (1) An accountable item shall be issued for delivery and if it is not delivered due to any reason on its first presentation, it shall be issued once again for delivery. In case of inability to deliver after two attempts, it shall, in no case, be issued again for delivery.
- (2) A notice of arrival of the accountable item, shall, however, be issued to the addressee for taking delivery of such item himself or by authorised person from the post office.

43. Addressee to sign in receipt.

- (1) The addressee of an accountable item or an authorised person, shall sign in the receipt and proof of delivery, in case relating thereto, of the item, unless the outward appearance of the cover gives rise to suspicion of tampering.
- (2) Where the outward appearance of the cover of the accountable item is suspected to be tempered, the item shall be opened at the post office, in the presence of the Postmaster, and to have its contents entered in an inventory, which shall be prepared in duplicate and shall be signed by the addressee.
- (3) One copy of the signed inventory shall be forwarded by the post office to the sender with unsigned proof of delivery attached to it and in case, the addressee or authorised person is not known to the staff of the post office from which the item is to be delivered, the identification of the addressee or authorised person by a person known to the post office staff, or the production of evidence which will establish his identity to the satisfaction of the Postmaster, shall be necessary if so, required by the delivering post office official.

44. Letter delivery box of items other than accountable items.

- (1) Items may be delivered in the post box or post bag for such addressee who has availed the facility of post box or post bag.

(2) In cases of non-availing of post box or post bag, items shall be delivered through a letter delivery box installed in the premises of the addressee.

(3) A letter delivery box with the name and address superscribed thereon and of such dimension as per the requirement of the addressee, shall be installed by the addressee on the ground floor of each of the house or buildings referred to in sub-regulation (2) in which the addressee is located and such letter delivery boxes shall be located at a convenient place which is easily accessible to the Postman or delivery person.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this sub-regulation, the term "building" refers to construction having two storeys or more, including high-rise buildings, and are in existence or construction of which has been completed;

Provided that a single letter delivery box may be provided as a common letter box by one or more or all the addressees located in a building or same floor of the building:

Provided further that where an item required to be delivered against receipt remains undelivered due to non-availability of the addressee, an intimation relating thereto may be given through the letter delivery box or through digital communication.

(4) Every such letter delivery box shall be provided with a posting aperture located at the top and facing the front, incorporating a horizontal ledge projecting inwards from the lower edge of the posting aperture.

(5) Where such a letter delivery box is not installed, the delivery of such items shall only be effected at the post office till the time the letter delivery box is installed.

(6) Where there is a genuine difficulty in complying with the provisions of this order in a particular building, the Divisional Head, for reasons to be recorded in writing, exempt the said building from the provisions of this regulation.

(7) Items of such size that cannot be delivered in a letter delivery box, and unpaid or insufficiently paid items shall be delivered to the addressee or authorised person or on the address, through the Postman or delivery person.

(8) The delivery of the unpaid or insufficiently paid items shall be made only after collection of the postage, required to be collected.

45. Window delivery.

The addressee of an item may avail the facility of receiving items at the post office during business hours without having the facility of post box or post bag system, by giving a written

request to the Postmaster without any charge and in such case, the item shall not be given to Postman for doorstep delivery.

46. Post box.

(1) The Post Offices at which Post Box is available, shall be determined by the Head of Circle.

Application Process:

(2) (a) The applicant shall make an application prescribed by the Head of the Circle, stating the exact nature of the business and furnish full particulars of his business address.

(b) In case of change in business address, customer shall invariably inform the Postmaster concerned regarding the change within seven days of such change. In the event of his failure to do so, the post box is liable to be withdrawn without notice or without any reason being assigned

(c) The Department reserve the right to withdraw the post box without notice or without any reason being assigned, in case of wrong information furnished in the application or misuse of the post box.

Renewal:

(3) Application for the renewal of the allotment of a post box shall be made to the Postmaster concerned at least 15 days before the expiry of the period for allotment.

Items to be delivered:

(4) Only fully prepaid unaccountable items addressed to the customer or c/o customer in whose name the post box stands registered, shall be delivered through post box bearing post box number.

Provided accountable items may also be delivered through post box if customer made a written request for the same to the postmaster concerned. Such delivery shall deem to be delivery to the addressee.

Manner of payment of fee and other charges:

(5) (a) The prescribed fee shall be paid in advance along with the application for allotment of a post box or for renewal thereof. Such fee shall, in no case, be refunded or adjusted.

(b) (i) A security deposit, as determined by the Head of the Circle, shall be paid on the allotment of a post box. Such deposit shall not be adjusted in whole or in part against the deposit or the fee due in respect of any other post box.

(ii) If the key of the lock, lock or both is lost, damaged or not in working condition, the customer shall bring the matter to the notice of the postmaster concerned within 7 days and credit the cost of repairing or replacing lock, key of the lock or both, failing which the deposit made by him shall be forfeited. On crediting of the cost, customer shall be supplied with a new lock, key or both, as the case may be, by the Postmaster.

Post Box and Post Bag Fees:

Post Box and Post Bag	Fee (in Rs.)
(a) Post Boxes or Bags if taken separately	
(i) If rented for full financial year	150
(ii) For three calendar months or part thereof, if rented for a period of less than a full financial year	50
(b) Post Box and Bag combined together with the same or different number	
(i) If rented for full financial year	250
(ii) For three calendar months or part thereof, if rented for a period of less than a full financial year	80

Period of allotment:

(6) The period of allotment of a post box commences from the first day of month in which the post box is allotted and the period of renewal of allotment commences from the first day of the month immediately succeeding the period of previous allotment.

Clearance of Post Box:

(7) (a) At the time of allotment of Post Box, Postmaster shall provide a delivery ticket, bearing same number as that allotted to the post box and is not transferable, to the customer which will be produced on demand.

(b) Customer may clear allotted post box at any time during the business hours of the post office.

(c) (i) Where any item addressed to a post box number cannot, in view of its size or for want of space in the box, be placed therein, the Postmaster shall arrange an intimation slip to this effect to be placed in the post box and the item will be kept in the delivery department.

(ii) On the customer or his messenger presenting the intimation slip together with the delivery ticket, the item shall be handed over to him.

47. Post bags.

- (a) The system of delivery of items in a bag, which along with a lock and duplicate key is to be supplied by the customer, is available at all delivery post offices, whether post box system is available there or not.
- (b) The foregoing provisions relating to the post boxes shall apply mutatis mutandis to the post bags, except in the following respects.
- (i) locked post bags with the items placed inside the bag is handed over to the customer or his messenger over the counter on the production of the delivery ticket during the hours prescribed for making window delivery;
- (ii) these bags with the exception of those allotment in combination with post box same number may be used by the customer for dispatching to the post office fully prepaid items for posting.

48. Smart delivery box.

- (1) The Circle Head is authorised to designate the post offices or other locations, where the services of the smart delivery box are available.
- (2) The service shall be availed by anyone by applying to the post office along with the fee or charge as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.
- (3) The smart delivery box shall be used for delivery of such items addressed to the assignee of the box as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

49. Delivery to public officers.

- (1) Items superscribed "On India Government Service", and containing in the address both the name and official designation of a public officer or does not contain the official designation, shall be delivered or redirected according to the official designation even when the person named no longer holds the appointment designated or has left the station.
- (2) Items which do not bear the superscription "On India Government Service", but contain in the address both the name and official designation of a public officer, shall be delivered or redirected according to the name, whereas items which do not contain the name in the address, shall be delivered according to the official designation of the addressee.

50. Special procedure for delivering items to firms, etc.

- (1) The items addressed for delivery to a firm or company, shall be delivered to the authorised person by the owner, partner, or proprietor, as the case may be.

(2) The authority letter shall be given by the owner or proprietor or partner, as the case may be, to the Postmaster of the delivery post office of the area where the office of the firm or company is situated.

51. Items addressed to deceased persons.

Items addressed to persons who are dead, shall be treated as if they were unclaimed and disposed of as per provisions of **sub regulation (2) of regulation 65**.

52. Delivery of damaged item.

Where an accountable item is received in the office of delivery in a damaged condition, a notice shall be sent to the addressee requesting him to attend the post office within **seven days** in the case of domestic item and **fifteen days** in the case of international item to take delivery and the delivery or disposal of such item shall be effected as may be specified by administrative instructions.

53. Intimation to addressee.

The intimation to the addressee shall be served by the Postman for accountable items as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

54. Seeking identification of addressee, if needed.

(1) The postman or delivery person may seek the identification of the addressee or authorised person before delivering the item, in case, the addressee or the authorised person is not known to him.

(2) The delivery of accountable items containing passport, Permanent Account Number (PAN) card, driving licence, and other items, shall be delivered only after seeking the identification of the recipient in a manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

55. Redirection of items.

(1) The sender of an item may avail the following facility in respect of the accountable domestic item and international inward item, by paying a postal fee Rs. 6/-, without reference to the consent of the addressee, namely

(a) recall of the item from the post:

Provided that the item may be cancelled before it has been dispatched from the office of booking for any reason as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time; or

(b) alteration in address or name of the addressee.

(2) The addressee of an item may avail the facility of alteration in address, free of charge in case where the original address and the substitute address are within the delivery area of the same post office; or otherwise by paying a postal fee, as mentioned in sub-regulation (1).

(3) The Post Office shall give a receipt of the applicable fees.

Procedure for Cancellation of an Article:

i. The sender or their authorized representative must submit a written request for cancellation at the same post office where the item was booked. This request should include:

- Original receipt of the booking.
- Item number and other booking details.
- Reason for cancellation.

ii. The sender or authorized representative must provide valid identification (such as Aadhaar card, PAN card, etc.) to verify their authority to cancel the article.

iii. The postal staff will verify if the article is still at the booking post office. If the article has not yet been dispatched, the cancellation request will be processed.

iv. If the cancellation request is approved, the item may be returned to the sender or his authorized representative under proper receipt upon verification of identity.

v. As far as refund is concerned, it is specified that no request of refund shall be entertained under any circumstances for domestic item containing documents. For other item, the refund amount will be processed based on the guidelines prescribed for that specific service

56. Request to avail certain facilities.

No request of the sender or addressee of an item, under **regulation 57** shall be entertained if the item is out for delivery at the destination post office, or has been seized, or confiscated, or destroyed under any applicable law of the land concerned.

57. Manner of making request.

(1) A sender or addressee or authorised person may make a written request for availing the facilities mentioned in regulation 55, with reasons, accompanied by the applicable fee, to the post office:

Provided that no such request shall be entertained in case of an item addressed to a foreign country or territory unless such item is addressed to a country or territory as may be specified by administrative instructions in this regard.

(2) Postage and applicable fee, once paid, shall, in no circumstances, be refunded.

58. Post Office not liable for non-fulfilment of request.

Subject to the conditions mentioned in **regulations 55 and 56**, the Post Office shall not be liable for non fulfilment of the request of the sender and shall not incur any liability by reason of delivery of any item contrary to an application made in this regard: Provided that, in such cases, the fee charged for such a request shall be refunded.

59. Postage payable on delivery.

The Postmaster or officer in-charge, shall ensure that the following classes of items are properly charged with postage in their presence:

- (a) insufficiently paid items that have been treated as fully prepaid;
- (b) unpaid items that are not impressed with the postage due stamp; and
- (c) items that have not been charged by the offices of dispatch with the full amount of postage due on them.

60. Postage-due stamp.

(1) The postage-due stamp shall be impressed on the items mentioned in regulation 59 and the amount shown by the impression of the postage due stamp of the office of dispatch shall be mentioned under the initials of the Postmaster or the officer in-charge or the authorised office or official.

(2) In the case of an item received by foreign post, postage shall not, under any circumstances, be charged by any post office other than the foreign post office through which it passes.

(3) If an unpaid item of the foreign post, which has not been impressed with the T - stamp by the office of origin and has not been taxed by the foreign post office through obvious error, is received in a post office for delivery, then such item shall be sent back to the foreign post office concerned to be properly taxed and shall be delivered on receipt back after recovery of the postage due:

Provided that items received with just printed impressions indicating the country or territory of origin and the phrase "Tax persue" meaning "charge collected", "Port paye" meaning "Postage Paid", or a similar expression in the language of the country or territory of origin, without any amount of the postage collected being indicated, shall not be taxed either by the offices of exchange or by the offices of delivery and shall be delivered as if fully prepaid.

61. Delivery of items on which customs duty is due.

Items on which customs duty to be recovered is in excess of the amount as specified by administrative instructions from time to time, shall ordinarily be delivered at the post office window and such duty may be paid either in cash or by cheque or by any other specified mode.

62. Refusal of items.

(1) The addressee of an item shall not be bound to pay the amount due on it to the post office, if he does not want to take delivery of it and in such case, the word "Refused" shall be written by the Postman across the cover.

(2) Unclaimed and refused items shall be returned, at once, direct to the offices of posting for delivery to the sender and if the sender of such items so returned to the office of posting cannot be found, the items shall then be sent to the Returned Letter Office.

(3) In respect of international item, such item shall be returned to the foreign post office for further disposal.

63. Obligation to pay sum charged.

When a person takes delivery of an item on which any sum is due to the Post Office, he shall pay the amount marked upon it.

64. Detention and disposal of undelivered items at post office of addressee.

(1) An item shall ordinarily be kept in deposit in the post office to which it is addressed for a period of seven days after all enquiries to find the addressee have proved unsuccessful.

(2) Delivery Post Offices will maintain a proper record of all such requests for retention and monitor the item held in deposit to ensure timely delivery or pickup within the prescribed period.

65. Undelivered items to be returned in certain cases.

(1) An undelivered item, of which the addressee-

(a) has refused, or after due notice omitted, to take delivery, or the addressee does not take delivery within the period as specified by administrative instructions from time to time; or

(b) is known to have left address without intimation to the post office as to the redirection of his correspondence; or

(c) is dead and there is no person to whom the item could properly be delivered, shall not be detained in the post office to which it is addressed and shall be returned to the sender if the

item bears clearly on the outside, the name and address of the sender, or otherwise sent to the Returned Letter Office concerned.

(2) The item referred to in sub-regulation (1) shall be delivered to the sender or authorised person and any proof of delivery attached thereto shall not be delivered and destroyed.

(3) In case of the item being undelivered to the sender, such item shall be sent to the Returned Letter Office (RLO) concerned.

66. Standard remarks on undelivered items.

(1) The reasons for non-delivery shall be recorded by use of the standard remarks, as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) The production of an item, having thereon the official mark of the Post Office denoting that the item has been dealt with as indicated by any of the standard remarks, as specified in sub-regulation (1) shall be proof of the fact so denoted and the person from whom the item is purported to have come, shall, until the contrary is proved, be deemed to be the sender thereof.

Standard Remarks and Procedures:

Sl. No.	Standard Remarks	Scenarios where Standard Remark to be used.	Final Disposal of the Article
1	Refused	Addressee is present but declines to accept the article for any reason.	Returned to sender
2	Addressee not found	Address is located, but the addressee is not available at the address in case of addressee specific delivery.	Keep in deposit for 7 days and if nobody claims, returned to sender
3	Addressee left without instructions	Addressee is known to have left without leaving forwarding instructions.	Returned to sender
4	Premises Locked	When multiple attempts are made, but the premises are consistently found closed.	Returned to sender
5	Insufficient Address	Address is incomplete or inadequate to locate the recipient despite best efforts.	Returned to sender
6	Unclaimed	Delivery attempt made and notice/intimation served, but item not collected within prescribed time.	Returned to sender
7	Deceased	Addressee has passed away.	Return to sender

Sl. No.	Standard Remarks	Scenarios where Standard Remark to be used.	Final Disposal of the Article
8	Redirected	Item forwarded to a new address based on addressee's written instructions.	Redirected on the same day
9	Missent	Item is received missent.	Item will be redirected to correct address/Post office for further delivery
10	No Such Person	No such person is residing at the address mentioned on the article	Returned to sender
11	Damage	Shall be dealt as per the prescribed procedure to deal such damaged articles.	-
12	Beat change	Item intended for some other beat but wrongly invoiced to some other beat.	To be invoiced to correct beat
13	Poste Restante	Poste Restante (C/o Postmaster) item will be kept with the Postmaster for 15 days and if not claimed, it will be returned to sender	Returned to sender (after 15 days)
14	Others	Any remarks which are not covered in Sl 1 to 14.	Suitable action will be taken

67. Detention and disposal of undelivered items at Returned Letter Office (RLO).

The items that remain undelivered to the address as well as the sender, shall be detained at Returned Letter Office for a period of -

(a) fifteen days when they are unaccountable; and (b) thirty days when they are accountable.

Explanation.- For the purpose of this rule, "Returned Letter Office" means an office that deals with unclaimed and refused items, or items without addresses, or with undecipherable or incomplete addresses.

68. Procedure in case of dealing undelivered items.

(1) The undelivered items referred to in regulation 64 to 66 shall be dealt with as follows: -

(a) items without intrinsic value, such as, items containing printed or handwritten papers, shall be disposed of forthwith by selling it as waste paper or destroyed;

(b) magazines, periodicals and newspapers may, at the option of the Regional Head, be used for any public purpose;

(c) items with intrinsic value shall be disposed of through auction;

(d) postcards and letter cards on which the postage has not been prepaid shall be destroyed forthwith;

Provided that nothing in this regulation shall prevent the immediate destruction of any item deemed necessary for public good.

(2) On the expiration of the period specified in regulation 67, the item shall be disposed of, in a manner as deemed fit by the Circle Head or the Regional Head concerned, in the Returned Letter Office.

69. Period for which intimation regarding change in address remain valid.

(1) A resident can give written intimation, regarding change in his residential or official address, to the concerned post office for delivery of the items addressed to him or to his address to the new address.

(2) Such intimation shall remain valid for a period not exceeding three months.

(3) the provisions of sub-regulation (2) of regulation 55 shall mutatis mutandis be applicable for delivery of items.

70. Officers or officials authorised to make an official mark.

(1) The following officers or officials are authorised to make an official mark on items denoting that any postage or other sum is due in respect thereof to the Post Office and such mark shall be the proof that the sum so denoted is due; and that the item has been refused or rejected or unclaimed, or cannot for any other reason be delivered: -

(a) Postmaster of the office;

(b) concerned supervisor and officials, who have been assigned with the work of delivery of the items;

(c) Postman or the authorised delivery person.

(2) In the cases related with branch post offices, the delegation of work, as referred to in sub-regulation (1) performed by the Post Master and Postman or authorised delivery person shall be performed by the Grameen Dak Sevak Branch Postmaster and Grameen Dak Sevak performing the work of delivery of items respectively.

(3) The procedure for the purposes of these regulations shall be as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

71. Recovery of dues in respect of unpaid and insufficiently paid domestic items.

Any item on which the postage or airmail fee thereon is not prepaid, or is insufficiently prepaid, shall, on delivery of the postal articles to the addressee or, in case of undeliverable, to the sender, be charged with the rates as mentioned in Table -

Rates Chargeable on Domestic Items

Condition	Charge
(i) On an unpaid item	Double the prepaid rate
(ii) On an insufficiently paid item	Double the deficiency

Note: The postage or air mail fee actually charged shall in no case be less than rupee one.

72. Recovery of dues in respect of unpaid and insufficiently paid international items.

(1) Any inward international item on which the postage or airmail fee thereon is not prepaid or is insufficiently prepaid, shall, on delivery of the postal articles to the addressee or, in case of undeliverable, to the sender, be charged with the rates as mentioned in Table

Rates Chargeable on International Items

Condition	Charge
(i) On an unpaid item	Double the prepaid rate
(ii) On an insufficiently paid item	Double the deficiency

Note: The postage or air mail fee actually charged shall in no case be less than rupee one.

(2) Any outward international item on which the postage or airmail fee thereon is not prepaid or is insufficiently prepaid, shall not be forwarded to the destination but shall be delivered to the sender without any charge.

CHAPTER IV

COMPENSATION

73. Compensation for loss, damage etc. of items.

(1) The Post Office shall be liable to pay compensation for loss of item, abstraction of content, loss of content, damage to content, or damage to item, for various categories of items, subject to the conditions as specified in this Chapter.

(2) The compensation shall be payable to the sender:

Provided that the compensation shall be payable to the addressee if the sender waives his right in favour of the addressee.

(3) The compensation for consequential loss or damage or any other such loss or damage shall not be payable.

74. Compensation for registered item.

(1) The compensation to be paid in respect of domestic registered items shall be Subject to a maximum of Rs. 100/- (Rupees One Hundred) or the actual value of contents, whichever is less.

(2) The compensation to be paid in respect of international registered items shall be 30 SDR.

75. Compensation for speed post item.

(1) The compensation to be paid in respect of domestic speed post items shall be:

(a) For loss of item, abstraction of content, loss of content, damage to content or damage to item: Double the Speed Post charges or Rs. 1,000/- (Rupees One Thousand), whichever is less.

(b) For delay in delivery: Speed Post charges.

(2) The compensation to be paid in respect of international speed post items (EMS) shall be:

(a) For loss of item, abstraction of content, loss of content, damage to content or damage to item: 30 SDR.

(b) For delay in delivery: Difference between the EMS charges and the registered post charges.

76. Compensation for insured item.

(1) The compensation to be paid in respect of domestic insured items shall be the insured value or the actual value of the contents, whichever is less.

(2) The compensation to be paid in respect of international insured items shall be Subject to a maximum of the insured value or the actual value of contents, whichever is less:

Provided that for loss of item, abstraction of content, loss of content, damage to content or damage to item, the compensation shall not exceed the insured amount.

77. Compensation for India Post Parcel.

The compensation to be paid in respect of India Post Parcel shall be **Subject to a maximum of Rs. 500/- (Rupees Five Hundred)** or the actual value of contents, whichever is less.

78. Compensation for International Air Parcel.

The compensation to be paid in respect of International Air Parcel shall be **40 SDR per parcel plus 4.50 SDR per kg.**

79. Compensation for International Tracked Packet.

The compensation to be paid in respect of International Tracked Packet shall be **Subject to a maximum of 30 SDR.**

80. Compensation for money remittance services.

(1) The compensation to be paid in respect of domestic money remittance services (e.g., Money Order) shall be:

(a) For loss of money order: The amount of money order plus the commission paid.

(b) For delay in payment: The interest at the rate of savings bank account for the period of delay on the amount of money order.

(2) The compensation to be paid in respect of international money remittance services shall be the amount of money remittance plus the commission paid.

81. Value Payable Post (VPP) / Cash on Delivery (COD).

(1) The compensation to be paid in respect of domestic VPP or COD items shall be:

(a) For loss of item: Subject to a maximum of Rs. 500/- or actual value of contents, whichever is less.

(b) If the amount has been collected from the addressee but not remitted to the sender: The amount collected.

(2) The Post Office shall not be liable for any compensation if the item has been delivered to the addressee and the amount has been remitted to the sender.

82. Conditions for payment of compensation.

(1) No compensation shall be payable:

- (a) if the claim is not made within the period specified in regulation 83;
- (b) if the loss or damage is caused by the fault or negligence of the sender or the addressee;
- (c) if the item contained anything prohibited from transmission by post;
- (d) if the item was seized or detained by any competent authority under any law for the time being in force;
- (e) if the sender has not packed the item securely;
- (f) in case of "force majeure" events (e.g., natural disasters, war, civil commotion).

(2) The decision of the Department of Posts regarding the payment of compensation shall be final.

83. Time limit for claiming compensation.

The claim for compensation shall be preferred within the following time limits from the date of booking of the item:

- (a) For domestic items: Three months.
- (b) For international items: Six months (or as per UPU regulations).

84. Procedure for claiming compensation.

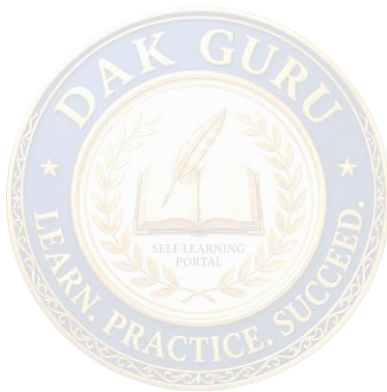
- (1) The claim for compensation shall be submitted to the office of booking or the office of delivery, in the form and manner as specified by administrative instructions.
- (2) The claimant shall produce the original receipt of booking along with the claim application.
- (3) The Department may require the claimant to produce evidence of the value of the contents.

85. Liability of the Post Office.

The liability of the Post Office shall be limited to the compensation amounts specified in this Chapter and shall not extend to any indirect or consequential loss or damage.

86. Ex gratia payment.

The Department of Posts may, in exceptional cases, consider ex gratia payment, subject to the approval of the Director General, Postal Services.



CHAPTER V

A. LETTER POST ITEMS

DOMESTIC ITEMS

87. Letters.

- (1) Letter is a communication in the nature of current and personal correspondence addressed to a person transmitted by post with pre-payment of postage.
- (2) Every letter shall be posted in securely closed condition.
- (3) The weight of the letter shall not exceed 500 grams.
- (4) Every letter for transmission by post shall conform to the following maximum and minimum dimensions, namely:-
 - (i) Maximum dimensions:
 - **In roll form:** Single dimension **800 mm**; Sum of length and twice diameter **1000 mm**.
 - **In other than roll form:** Single dimension 600 mm; Sum of length and breadth and thickness combined 900 mm.
 - (ii) Minimum dimensions:
 - **In roll form:** Single dimension **100 mm**; Sum of length and twice diameter **170 mm**.
 - **In other than roll form:** **140 mm x 90 mm** with tolerance of **+/- 2mm**.

88. Letters in other than roll form.

- (1) Letter in other than roll form shall be in envelopes of the following sizes;
 - (a) minimum 140 x 90 mm; and (b) maximum 458 x 324 mm; with tolerance of +/- 2 mm.
- (2) Every envelope shall have the flap either at the top on back of the longer side or at right or left.
- (3) Every envelope shall be made of paper having thickness from 0.15 mm to 0.5 mm.
- (4) Surface of the envelope shall be levelled with uniform surface structure.
- (5) Every envelope shall be continuously closed on all sides taking care to avoid a residue of gum on the envelope itself and metal clips or staples shall not be used for closing the envelope.
- (6) Every envelope shall be made of minimum 70 Grams per Square Meter.

- (7) Every envelope shall be flexible enough to bend into "U shape".
- (8) Every envelope with window shall have sizes of window between 35-50 mm (breadth) and 80-125 mm (length) and the contents shall be placed in such manner that only address block which includes bar code shall be visible through window.
- (9) Glassine paper of 35 Grams per Square Meter, Cellophane paper of 40 Grams per Square Meter and Polyvinyl Chloride or Biaxially Oriented Polypropylene of 15-micron thickness shall be used as window material.
- (10) Distance of left edge of window from left edge of envelope shall be minimum 15 mm, distance of top edge of window shall be minimum 40 mm, and distance of bottom edge of window from bottom edge of envelope shall be minimum 15 mm.
- (11) Logo and name of the sender's company may be written on top left corner and stamps or frank impression on top right corner having gap of minimum 10 mm from address block of recipient.
- (12) 15 mm shall be left for bar code printing at the bottom of envelope and 5 mm quiet space around 2D barcode or Quick Response Code shall be provided and the sender's logo size shall not exceed 25x50 mm in size and the 2D barcode or Quick Response Code shall have minimum size 18x18 mm.
- (13) The size of printed bar code or digital code along with quiet zone shall be kept minimum 60 mm in length and 10 mm in breadth in a window of envelope and shall be clearly visible.
- (14) In case of infringement of the conditions mentioned in regulation 87 and sub regulation (1) to (13) of regulation 88, the letter shall be charged with double the postage and any postage paid on it shall be taken into account in assessing the charges.
- (15) The discount and value additions to the customers for letters may be specified by administrative instructions in accordance with the norms determined by the Director General from time to time.
- (16) The rates of postage chargeable on letters shall be as mentioned in as under -

(a) Letters

Weight Slab	Rate
(i) For a weight not exceeding twenty grams	₹ 5/-
(ii) For every twenty grams or fraction thereof	₹ 5/-

89. Letter cards.

Letter cards may be transmitted by post, if it conforms to the following specifications, namely: -

- (a) the postage shall be prepaid in full;
- (b) the weight of the letter card shall not exceed five grams;
- (c) the dimensions of the letter card including its flaps when unfolded or folded shall respectively be as follows: -

Dimension	Unfolded	Folded
Maximum	300 mm × 210 mm	210 mm × 100 mm
Minimum	282 mm × 182 mm	152 mm × 90 mm

Flaps — the letter card shall have three flaps, one each on the left and right side not exceeding 15 mm × 100 mm and another on the top side not exceeding 15 mm × 210 mm; the flaps may not be required if the letter card can be closed by any other effective process.

- (d) nothing shall be attached to or enclosed in a letter card;
- (e) there shall be printed on the outside at the top left-hand corner on the address side of every folded letter intended for domestic transmission the words "Letter Card"; and
- (f) letter card shall be made of paper of minimum 70 Grams per Square Meter.

Explanation 1.- For the purposes of this regulation, "Letter card" means a sheet of paper of the kind ordinarily used for letter writing suitably folded and gummed.

Explanation 2.- Letter cards of private manufacture shall be suitably folded and fully closed on three sides by continuous gumming, glue or any other adhesive provided the dimensions and other conditions mentioned in this regulation are complied with.

90. Conditions where infringed.

- (1) In case of infringement of the conditions specified in regulation 89, the letter card shall be treated as a letter and charged on delivery with double the deficiency between the postage already paid for such letter card and the postage payable for a letter.
- (2) The rates of postage chargeable on letter cards shall be as mentioned as under –

(b) Letter Cards

Item	Rate
For a letter card	₹ 2.50/-

91. Postcards.

(1) Postcards may be transmitted by post, if it shall conform to the following conditions, namely:

- (a) the postage shall be prepaid in full;
- (b) the weight of the post card shall not exceed five grams;
- (c) their dimensions shall be 140 mm x 90 mm and they shall have the legend, "Post Card" written in Hindi or English or printed on the address side;
- (d) as regards substance, they shall be neither thinner nor more flexible than the post cards issued by the Post Office;
- (e) no post card shall be folded, enclosed in any cover, cut or otherwise altered except that the impressed postage stamp (if any) may be perforated with initials;
- (f) the right-hand of the address-side of a postcard is in all cases reserved for the address of the recipient, for the postage stamp or impression of stamping machine necessary for prepayment, which may, so far as possible, be affixed in the upper righthand corner, and for the postal directions but the left hand half of the address-side, as well as the back, may be used by the sender for the purpose of a communication or single colour or multi colour printed advertisement and address of the sender may be written on top left-hand corner of back, or may be otherwise disposed of, subject to the restriction mentioned in sub-regulation (g):

Provided that a small space marked off by lines or minute dots to indicate the place where the postage stamp is to be affixed, shall be allowed on the upper righthand corner of the address-side of postcards;

- (g) nothing shall be attached to a post card except-
 - (i) stamps in payment of postage or other postal fees which shall be affixed only to the address side of the post card;
 - (ii) a gummed label completely adherent to the card, and bearing the name and address of the person to whom the card is sent;

- (iii) a similar label not exceeding 50 mm in length and 20 mm in width bearing the name and address of the sender of the card; and
- (iv) engravings, illustrations, drawings and photographs on very thin paper and completely adherent to the card.

Provided that the items specified in sub-clauses (ii) and (iii) shall be affixed either to the back or the left-hand half of the address side.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this regulation, "Post card" means an open communication on a rectangular card of prescribed size, having a stamp of the prescribed value impressed on it.

(2) In case of infringement of any of the conditions specified in sub-regulation (1), the postcard shall be treated as a letter and charged on delivery with double the deficiency between the postage already paid for such postcard and the postage payable for a letter subject to a minimum of one rupee, and where such amount is a part of a rupee containing paise, the amount shall be increased to one rupee.

(3) The rates of postage chargeable on postcard shall be as mentioned in as under -

(c) Postcards

Item	Rate
For a Postcard	50 paise

92. Book post.

(1) Item containing book, cards, magazines, journals, publications of all kinds, paper, sheets, bills, invoices, reports, or any document of commercial, legal or personal nature in single or multiple copies, may be transmitted by post as "book post", subject to the following conditions, namely: -

(a) a book post shall not exceed 5 kilograms in weight;

(b) the dimensions of a book post shall be subject to the following maximum and minimum limits: -

(i) Maximum:

- In roll form - length **800 mm**; Sum of length and twice diameter **1000 mm**
- In other than roll form - 600 x 300 x 300 mm

(ii) Minimum:

- In roll form - Single dimension **100 mm**; Sum of length and twice diameter **170 mm**
- In other than roll form - 140 mm x 90 mm with tolerance of ± 2 mm;

(c) book post when sent open in card form, whether folded or not shall be neither thinner nor more flexible than postcard;

(d) book post shall be consigned in an unfastened envelope of the following sizes, provided its dimensions are not less than 140 x 90 mm and not more than 353 x 250 mm; with tolerance of ± 2 mm;

(e) the item shall have the inscription "Book Post" on the address side of the item;

(f) a book post shall be posted without a cover, or in an unfastened envelope, or in a cover under "Book Post", which can be easily removed for the purpose of examination without breaking any seal or tearing any paper or separating any adhering surfaces and a packet posted without a cover may not be fastened or otherwise treated so as to prevent easy examination;

(g) a book post shall not contain "paper money", which for the purposes of this regulation includes unobliterated postage or other stamps, hundies, cheques, bank post bills, bills of exchange, and all orders or authorities for the payment of money:

Provided that a book post may contain one stamped and addressed envelope, post card or wrapper bearing the name and address of the sender of the packet, or some other person named thereon;

(h) any document contained in the book post item shall not be addressed to an addressee nor stem from a sender other than those of the item:

Provided that all items posted as book post shall be treated as letter post if the weight is upto 500 gms, or as parcel post if the weight is more than 500 gms.

(2) In case of infringement of any of the conditions mentioned in sub-regulation (1), the book post shall be treated as a letter and on delivery, be charged with double the postage payable on letter or India post parcel according to whichever entails lower charge (subject to the conditions prescribed for such class of items being satisfied) and any postage paid on it shall be taken into account in assessing the charges.

(3) The rates of postage chargeable on book post shall be as mentioned as under-

(d) Book Post

Weight Slab	Rate
(i) For the first fifty grams or fraction thereof	₹ 4/-
(ii) For every additional fifty grams or fraction thereof in excess of fifty grams	₹ 3/-

92 A. GYAN POST.

(1) A book or packet containing the books related with the following, may be transmitted as a "Gyan Post" item, subject to the conditions mentioned in sub regulations (2):

(a) prescribed in syllabus for correspondence and regular courses for students by:

(i) recognized boards of education, universities of the Government;

(ii) autonomous bodies and statutory bodies under the Government

(b) containing the literature related with social, cultural and religious nature issued or published in accordance with relevant law of the land;

(c) text book used by aspirants of various competitive examinations

Explanation.- (1) "Book" includes every volume, part or division of a volume, in any language and every sheet of music, map, chart or plan separately printed and consists wholly or substantially of reading matter, paintings, photographs, diagrams or any other similar matter, with or without blank spaces, for notations by students.

(2) Government means Central Government, State Government or Government of the Union Territories.

(2) A Book or packet containing the books shall be transmitted under the "Gyan Post" subject to the following:

(a) They shall not contain any publication, published at regular intervals;

Illustration- Magazines, journal or similar publication issued at a regular interval of time weekly, fortnightly, monthly, bi-monthly, quarterly, half yearly and so- on.

(b) Such packet containing the books shall bear on the outside the inscription "Gyan Post";

(c) Books shall not contain any advertisements other than incidental announcements or list of books;

(d) Each book in such packet shall contain the name of the printer or publisher;

(e) No book of business or commercial in nature, shall be sent through this product;

(f) No book in such packet shall bear any character or inscription reproduced by any means other than printing or manuscript:

Provided that any such publication may contain in writing the name of the person to whom it is sent or presented, the date, the name and address of the sender or owner or initials of a complimentary nature or signifying presentation.

(g) No publication in such packet shall contain any price list or bills or orders for supply of the books:

Provided that the packet may contain an invoice or a bill or both pertaining to publication being sent in that packet.

(3) The items booked under "Gyan Post" shall be transmitted as trackable item. No item under Gyan Post category shall be transmitted as untracked or ordinary item.

(4) The item posted as Gyan Post shall be address specific.

(5) The packets booked under this category, shall be transmitted through surface mode.

(6) The value-added service of registration, proof of delivery and insurance, may be availed by the sender on payment of applicable fees or charges.

(7) The said item must have a delivery address and the sender's return address and are subject to inspection by the post office officers and officials.

(8) Upon such inspection, matter not eligible for the processing under the Gyan Post product or in case of infringement of the conditions mentioned in (a) to (g) above, the packet sent under this product, shall be treated as an item posted through India Post Parcel - Retail product and charged on delivery with double the deficiency between the postage already paid for such packet and the postage payable for an India Post Parcel - Retail product item.

(9) The minimum weight for booking packet under "Gyan Post" shall be three hundred gms. and the maximum weight for which packet under this product may be booked, shall be five kg.

(10) The operational conditions for posting, booking, transmission and delivery of items under Gyan Post, shall be, as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

The rate for postage of Gyan post item (exclusive of applicable taxes)

Weight of item	Rate of postage (in Rs.)
Upto 300 grams	20
Between 301 to 500 gms	25

Weight of item	Rate of postage (in Rs.)
Between 501 to 1000 gms	35
Between 1001 to 2000 gms	50
Between 2001 to 3000 gms	65
Between 3001 to 4000 gms	80
Between 4001 to 5000 gms	100

93. Literature for blind.

(1) Papers of any kind, periodicals, and books impressed in "Braille" or other special type for the use of the blind, shall be transmitted by post as "Literature for the Blind" items, provided that they are posted in accordance with the following conditions, namely:

(a) such items shall consist only of materials specially impressed as described above for the use of the blind, and shall not contain any communication either in writing or printed in ordinary type, except the title and table of contents of the book or periodicals, and any key to, or instructions, for the use of the special type, or any enclosure except a label for the return of the packet;

(b) such items shall bear on the outside the inscription "Literature for the Blind" and written or printed name and address of the sender;

(c) such items shall be posted either without a cover, or in a cover open at both ends, which can easily be removed for the purpose of examination;

(d) the weight of a "Literature for the Blind" item shall not exceed 7 kilograms; and

(e) the dimensions of such item shall conform to the following maximum and minimum limits:

(i) Maximum:

- In roll form - Length **800 mm**; Sum of length and twice diameter **1000 mm**
- In other than roll form - 600 x 300 x 300 mm

(ii) Minimum:

- In roll form - Length **100 mm**; Sum of length and twice diameter **170 mm**
- In other than roll form - 100 x 70 mm

Explanation.- Plates bearing the characters of writing sound records for the use of the blind and discs, films, tapes and wires, on which spoken messages for the blind have been

recorded when sent by, or addressed to, an officially recognised institution for the blind shall be treated as "Literature for the Blind".

(2) No postage shall be chargeable on the literature for the blind, but air mail fee shall be chargeable for transmission by air.

(3) In case of infringement of any of the conditions mentioned in sub-regulation (1), the "Literature for the Blind" item shall be charged with double the postage as payable on relevant postal item, as applicable.

94. Periodical Post.

(1) Any publication may be transmitted by post as periodical post, if it is-

(a) covered under the definition of the term "periodical" under the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023);

(b) brought out, printed, or published in India only;

(c) registered with the Press Registrar General of India under the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023) and possesses the certificate of registration allotted by the Press Registrar of General; and

(d) comply with the provisions of the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023).

Provided that a book, or a journal including a book or journal of scientific, technical and academic nature shall not be transmitted by post as periodicals.

(2) No separate postal registration shall be required for transmission of periodicals by post.

Provided that for the periodicals which are covered under the definition of newspaper and wish to avail concessional rate of postage for transmission by post, a separate postal registration or license is required to be taken by the owner or publisher (under the authority of owner).

(3) The periodical shall bear in print on any convenient place either on the first or last page thereof, the superscription "Press Registrar of General of India under No.."

(4) In case of infringement of any of the conditions specified in sub-regulation (1) and (3), the item shall be treated and charged as a book post item and any postage paid on it shall be taken into account in assessing the charges.

(5) The rates of postage chargeable on periodical post shall be as mentioned as under -

Periodical Post

Value of Periodical	Rate
(i) From 1/- to 20/-	2/- for first 100 gms and part thereof, and 3/- for every additional 100 grams and part thereof
(ii) From 21/- to 50/-	4/- for first 100 gms and part thereof, and 5/- for every additional 100 gms and part thereof
(iii) 51/- and above	8/- for first 100 gms and part thereof, and 9/- for every additional 100 gms and part thereof

95. Registered newspapers.

(1) A newspaper shall be eligible for postal registration for transmission by post as registered newspaper, if it is-

(a) covered under the definition of the term "newspaper" under the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023);

(b) brought out, printed, or published in India only;

(c) registered with the Press Registrar General of India under the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023) and possesses the certificate of registration allotted by the Press Registrar of General; and

(d) comply with the provisions of the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023).

As per the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023, newspaper is defined as under:

"Newspaper" means a periodical of loose-folded sheets usually printed on newsprint and brought out daily or at least once in a week, containing information on current events, public news or comments on public news.

- The newspaper shall have been registered in the office of the Head of the Division and Independent Gazetted Postmasters in jurisdiction in which it is published.
- It is applied in application in the form prescribed along with **two copies** of the latest issue of the newspaper, and a copy of valid certificate of registration issued by the Press Registrar General.
- Postal registration shall be granted to a newspaper within **30 days** from the receipt of application form.
- The date of the publication of the newspaper shall be printed on the first or last page.

- The name of office of posting shall be printed mandatorily at convenient place in the back page top left corner of newspaper in such a manner that it is clearly visible.
- The newspaper shall be posted at a place specified in application for postal registration, by its owner, manager or publisher on such day(s) of the week not exceeding **seven days** which may have been specified by him at the time of application for postal registration or at any time subsequent thereto subject to that it does not violate the conditions for the newspaper.
- Provided that in case the date of posting is a Sunday or a gazetted holiday, facility of posting registered newspapers shall be available on the succeeding working day.
- Provided that a prior intimation of **two days** shall be given to the Postmaster concerned in case any change is desired in the dates or days of posting so specified or in case of inability to publish and posting the newspaper at any occasion or continuously for a specific period.
- Provided further that the requirement of two days' prior intimation may be waived off by the Head of the Division or independent Gazetted Postmaster, if he is satisfied that the owner, manager, publisher or agent could not adhere to it for the reasons beyond his control.
- Provided also that the number of days or dates on which an issue can be posted shall be altered with the prior approval of the Head of Division or independent Gazetted Postmaster.
- Provided further that a newspaper shall, in no case, be published and posted less than half of its issues in a calendar year.
- The publisher may post copies more than number of copies authorized to be posted only if **two days'** prior intimation, in writing, is given to the postmaster concerned. No objection will be raised, if the number of copies posted is less than the number of copies authorized to be posted.
- A publisher is allowed to post newspapers at a place outside the jurisdiction of the Registering Authority Permission for such posting will be granted by the Head of Circle/Head of Region concerned under whose jurisdiction the requested place of posting after satisfying himself about the genuineness of original postal registration from the Registration Authority.
- In cases of change in title of the newspaper, place of publication within or beyond the jurisdiction of the current registration authority ownership of a newspaper a fresh registration shall be required by due procedure.
- Provided that price and its printing on the newspaper shall not be mandatory on the newspaper published by Ministries/Department under the Government of India only
- The weight of a registered newspaper, either single copy or packet, shall not exceed **5 kilograms**.
- The newspaper shall bear in print in any convenient place either on the first or last page the word "**Registered**" followed by the registration number which has been assigned to it by the Head of the Division and Independent Gazetted Postmaster

- First registration shall be remained in force till **31st December** of the third calendar year following that in which it was effected. Every subsequent renewal of registration shall remain in force for **three calendar years**.
- Application for renewal of registration shall be made so as to reach the officer concerned at least **three months** before the date of expiry of the previous registration and shall be accompanied by **two copies** of the latest issue of the publication of the newspaper.
- No fee shall be payable for the renewal of registration or at the time of registration.
- A late fee of **Rs. 50/-** shall be charged for each application for renewal received later than the last working day of the third calendar month preceding the last month of the period of previous registration.
- Where the application for renewal is received after the date of expiry of the previous registration, a late fee of **Rs. 100/-** shall be charged with such application.
- Postal registration of a newspaper shall be renewed within **15 days** from the receipt of application form.
- The newspaper applying for RNP must have some price and its printing on newspaper is mandatory. Provided that price and its printing on the newspaper shall not be mandatory on the newspaper(s) published by Ministries/Departments of Government of India only.
- The Head of Circle/Head of Region grants the permission of posting without prepayment.
- The owner or publisher who intends to post **more than 500 copies** of registered newspapers at a time, is, by a valid licence, eligible to post newspapers without affixing postage confined to Registered Newspapers.
- The license number is required to be printed along with the words "**Licensed to post without prepayment**" below or after the Postal registration Number. The licensee may also use the abbreviated version, instead of the complete phrase as above, by substituting the phrase with the term "**WPP**" as prefix before the license number.
- **Security for WPP:** - Equivalent to the total of **one month** postage as security deposit.
- **Bill for WPP:** -
 - On **16th day of Month:** - Posting of RNP between 1st to 15th
 - On **1st day of Next Month:** - Posting of RNP between 16th to end of previous month.
- The payment of bill should be made by the licensee at the office indicated in bill within **7 days**.
- In the event of non-payment of a bill within a **fortnight**, the posting of the Newspaper without prepayment of postage will be immediately be stopped the licence deemed to have been cancelled.

- If any dispute arises as to the effect of the licence or with regard to any matter arising therefrom, the same should be referred for a decision to the Member (Operations), whose decision shall be final.

(3) The rates of postage on registered newspaper are mentioned in as under -

Item / Weight Slab	Rate
(a) In the case of a single copy of a registered newspaper:	
(i) For a weight not exceeding fifty grams	25 paise
(ii) For a weight exceeding fifty grams but not exceeding one hundred grams	50 paise
(iii) For every additional one hundred grams or fraction thereof exceeding one hundred grams	20 paise
(b) In the case of more than one copy of the same issue of a registered newspaper being carried in the same packet:	
(i) For a weight not exceeding 100 grams	50 paise
(ii) For every additional one hundred grams or fraction thereof, exceeding one hundred gms.	20 paise

Provided that such a packet shall not be delivered at any addressee 's residence but shall be given to a recognized agent at the post office.

96. India post parcel.

(1) The Post Office shall offer India post parcel to individual and bulk customers and all parcels shall be treated as accountable items.

(2) Any item shall be treated as an India post parcel, if it complies with at least one of the following conditions, namely: -

(a) which weighs more than 500 grams; or

(b) which has minimum dimensions of:

(i) 100 mm in roll form, sum of length and twice diameter 170 mm;

(ii) 140 x 90 mm in other than roll form; With a tolerance of +2 mm; and

(c) whose length does not exceed 1.5 metres and the length and girth combined does not exceed 3 meters; and

(d) whose gross weight does not exceed 35 kgs or volumetric weight as defined;

Provided that where the item is not a letter item as defined in regulation sub regulation (1) of 87 shall be declared as "merchandise" by the customer.

(3) Any India post parcel presented at the window shall have the inscription "India Post Parcel" on it with such value additions as may be paid for, by the sender.

(4) The postage on an India post parcel shall be fully pre-paid through any of the modes of payment as mentioned in rule 9.

- **Note 1:** Franking Impressions of such models of franking machines of vendors approved by the Director General shall be deemed to be mode of prepayment of postage on an item.
- **Note 2:** Nothing contained in this regulation shall prevent the booking of India post parcels where the postage is collected at a later stage as permitted by the Director General.

(5) India post parcel shall ordinarily be transmitted by surface only.

(6) The value-added services, that is, addressee specific delivery, cash on delivery, insurance and proof of delivery, shall be available for India post parcel on payment of a fee specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(7) All India post parcels shall be packaged by the sender or by the post office as specified by administrative instructions from time to time and any India post parcel not packed in conformity with specifications shall not be accepted for booking.

(8) If any India post parcel in the course of transmission through post, is found to consist of anything the transmission of which is in contravention of the provisions of the Act or the rules, it shall be detained at the post office nearest to the place at which it is detected shall be dealt in the manner as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(9) Every India post parcel addressed to any part of India shall be accompanied by a declaration in a form as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(10) All India post parcels shall be booked, transmitted and delivered in the manner as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(11) The rates of postage chargeable on India post parcels are mentioned as under -

India Post Parcel — Retail (Table III)

In force from 1 August 2026. A uniform, **zone-based** tariff (Local / Within State / Zone or Metro / Other States) replaces the earlier flat PAN-India retail rate of ₹36 for the first 500 g. (*Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2026 — S.O. 4241(E) dated 31.07.2026.*)

Weight Slab	Local	Within State	Zone / Metro	Other States
Up to 500 g	28	65	70	72
501 – 1000 g	48	91	106	114
1001 – 1500 g	60	117	142	171
1501 – 2000 g	87	160	198	239
2001 – 3000 g	116	219	277	337
3001 – 4000 g	145	268	344	420
4001 – 5000 g	174	324	420	515
Every additional 1 kg	30	50	70	90

(Tariff in ₹. GST levied as applicable.)

India Post Parcel — Contractual (Table III)

The earlier state-based contractual pricing is replaced by the same zone structure.

Weight Slab	Local	Within State	Zone / Metro	Other States
Up to 500 g	27	31	34	35
501 – 1000 g	31	44	51	57
1001 – 1500 g	36	58	70	80
1501 – 2000 g	45	80	100	115
2001 – 3000 g	57	100	125	145
3001 – 4000 g	69	120	150	175
4001 – 5000 g	81	140	175	205
Every additional 1 kg	15	20	25	30

(Tariff in ₹. GST levied as applicable.)

96A. India Post Parcel Last Mile.

(New regulation inserted by the Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2026 — S.O. 4241(E) dated 31.07.2026, in force 1 August 2026.)

(1) Apart from India Post Parcel under regulation 96, an **India Post Parcel Last Mile** service is available, to be **booked at the office of delivery** of the parcel, or at an **identified parcel hub or parcel processing centre**, for delivery **within the local jurisdiction** of that office.

(2) The service is available **only to bulk or corporate customers** who enter into an agreement with the Department of Posts.

- (3) Proof of delivery, insurance, cash on delivery and other value-added services are available on payment of the fee applicable to India Post Parcel.
- (4) The weight slab and postage are as specified in **Table III A** of Schedule I; postage is charged on the **volumetric weight or gross weight, whichever is higher**.
- (5) The parcel is delivered at the given address, unless otherwise specified.
- (6) The compensation provisions in Table V of Schedule I (India Post Parcel) apply *mutatis mutandis* to this service.

Table III A — India Post Parcel Last Mile

Weight Slab	Booked / inducted at Delivery Office	Booked / inducted at identified parcel hub or PPC
Up to 2000 g	15	20
2001 – 5000 g*	22	35

(Tariff in ₹. GST as applicable. *Maximum permissible weight = 5 kg.)

Zone & Metro categorisation (Parcel Directorate clarification No. 39-09/2025-PD dated 05.08.2026):

- **North Zone:** J&K, Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, Haryana, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh (UTs: J&K, Ladakh, Chandigarh, Delhi).
- **South Zone:** Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Telangana (UTs: Lakshadweep, Puducherry).
- **East Zone:** Bihar, West Bengal, Assam, North-East, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Odisha (UT: Andaman & Nicobar).
- **West Zone:** Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Maharashtra (UT: Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman).
- **Metro cities:** Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad (Chennai, Bengaluru & Hyderabad fall in the same zone).
- Where Zone and Metro rates differ, **Zone tariff takes priority**, then Metro (presently the two are identical).
- **APS bookings:** shipments addressed to Army Postal Service offices are treated as “Other State” irrespective of booking location.
- **Local:** the municipal areas of NCR of Delhi (all districts), Faridabad, Ghaziabad, Gurgaon and Gautam Budh Nagar are treated as *Local*; the same principle applies to other urban agglomerations.

97. Logistic post.

(1) The Circle Heads are authorised to specify, by administrative instructions, from time to time, the designated office and designated place where the items under "Logistics Post" may be booked at or addressed to.

(2) The operational conditions for posting, booking, transmission and delivery of items under Logistics Post, shall be, as specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

- Logistics Post offer a range of integrated distribution solutions including door to door delivery, warehousing, pick and pack facility, distribution and returns management. It will provide end to end supply chain management to the customers by offering value added services.
- While Speed Post Parcel and India Post Parcel handle products up to 35 Kgs. Logistics Post books Parcels without any specific weight limit. The first slab under Logistics Post, for the purpose of calculation of tariff is 50 Kgs.

Services offered:

In addition to basic service comprising booking, transportation, unloading and delivery of goods at India Post premises (Logistics Post Centre) following optional Value added Services should also be available on payment of extra charges for each service.

- Pick up
- Loading
- Door delivery, including unloading
- Storage of goods before dispatch and or delivery

Tariff for Logistic Post:

- Considering the hidden/unexpected cost that may creep in, Circle may decide the costing keeping at least **20% margin** over the tentative Operational cost. However, Head of Circle, would have discretion to vary the margin freely where consignment weigh **more than 100 Kgs**, as long as minimum margin of **10%** is ensured.
- All taxes/octroi/toll tax etc. would have to be paid by the consignor.
- When booked under Logistics Post, each consignment would be charged for a minimum weight of **50 Kgs**.
- There will be no maximum weight limit, but Logistics Post Centers can refuse articles, which cannot be carried by the means of transport available to them.

Weight-volume relationship:

- An article/consignment of the size/volume of **10 Cubic feet** would be treated as equivalent to **50 Kgs**.
- Every additional cubic foot or part thereof would be treated as equivalent to **5 Kgs**.
- However, for the purpose of charging, higher of the actual weight or notional weight worked out on volume basis, would be taken as the weight of the article/consignment.

- The volume of different shapes like spherical, cylindrical, conical, rectangular, square etc. would be calculated on standard mathematical formulae, which would be supplied by Circles to Logistics Post Centres.

INSURANCE:

- Head of Circle may enter into an arrangement with third party insurance company to offer insurance for Logistics Post.
- **Limit of liability:** The limit of liability per transit would be **Rs. 1 crore**.
- The consignors would be free to insure their goods with either third party insurer engaged by the Department of Posts or any insurer. Department of Posts would not be liable to compensate either the consignor/consignee, or any insurer. Consignor has to claim directly from the insurance provider. This should be made clear in the booking cum delivery challan.
- Logistics Post Centre will prepare a delivery challan in five copies, in Form B. The copies would be distributed as under: Office copy, Consignor's copy, Driver's copy, Insurer's copy, Destination Logistics Post Centre's copy.

DELIVERY:

- The consignments would be deliverable at the Logistics Post Centres. Depending on the consignor's directions, the consignment may be delivery in one lot to one consignee, or to multiple persons as per directions of the consignor (in pre-packed and addressed cartons for the time being).
- If the consignee does not take the delivery within **48 hours**, demurrage charges, equivalent to **double the charges for storage**, shall be charged.

98 : Speed Post

Speed Post is offered as two streams — **Speed Post Document** (regulation 99, tariff below) and **Speed Post Parcel** (regulation 100). What qualifies as a *document* was **clarified with effect from 1 August 2026** by the Post Office (Fifth Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (S.O. 4053(E) dated 23.07.2026), which substituted the Note under regulation 98(1):

Note 1 (regulation 98). A *document* may contain a letter as defined in regulation 87(1), or any other written, drawn or printed communication, or a package containing complimentary items or items having **no re-sale value**, which shall include —

- (a) **Banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) items** — welcome kits or letters, passbooks, cheque books, bank statements, plastic cards, debit cards and credit cards;
- (b) **Government documents** — PAN cards, Aadhaar cards, Electoral Photo Identity cards, passports, driving licenses; and
- (c) items **up to 500 g** — Rakhi envelopes/packages, greeting cards/packages — **except merchandise or commercial items**.

Note 2. All items **other than** those referred to in Note 1 shall be dealt with under the **Parcel** category.

99. Speed Post Document :

(1) Every speed post document shall be transmitted by air:

Provided that, speed post document may be transmitted by surface on routes where it is determined to be faster than air transmission.

(2) The weight of an item for the speed post document shall not exceed 500 grams including volumetric weight.

(3) The postage and other fees chargeable on the speed post document item, shall be charged in accordance with the volumetric weight or gross weight, whichever is higher.

(4) The size of an item for speed post document shall not exceed the dimension of 420 mm, 297 mm and 24 mm in respect of length, breadth and thickness, respectively.

(5) The pick-up facility, proof of delivery, insurance, registration and other value-added services as specified by administrative instructions from time to time, shall be available for speed post item on payment of fees specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(6) The item posted under the speed post shall generally be address specific that is it shall be delivered at the given address, unless otherwise specified.

STATUTORY UPDATE: Speed Post Tariff Revision (Effective 01.10.2025)

The tariff for **Inland Speed Post (Documents)** was revised with effect from **1 October 2025** by the **Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025** (which amended regulation 98(2)) — the first revision in 13 years. (*Secondary sources cite the gazette variously as S.O. 4256 or S.O. 4375(E) dated 25.09.2025; the exact S.O. number should be confirmed against the official gazette.*) This **document** tariff **remains in force** — it was not disturbed by the July–August 2026 amendments (which touched the premium 24/48 Speed Post and the parcel tariffs). Rates (GST extra):

Weight	Local	Up to 200 Km	201-500 Km	501-1000 Km	1001-2000 Km	Above 2000 Km
Up to 50g	₹ 19	₹ 47	₹ 47	₹ 47	₹ 47	₹ 47
51g to 250g	₹ 24	₹ 59	₹ 63	₹ 68	₹ 72	₹ 77
251g to 500g	₹ 28	₹ 70	₹ 75	₹ 82	₹ 86	₹ 93

Note on Additional Weight:

For every additional 500g or part thereof:

- **Local:** ₹ 10
- **Up to 200 Km:** ₹ 15
- **> 200 Km:** Ranges from ₹ 30 to ₹ 50 depending on distance.

Value Added Services:

- **Registration:** ₹ 5* per item.
- **OTP Based Delivery:** ₹ 5* per item.

*Fee excluding GST

100. Speed Post Parcel :

(1) Sub-regulations (1), (2), (4), (6), (7) to (10) of regulation 96, relating to India post parcels shall apply mutatis mutandis to speed post parcels, except as follows: -

(a) every speed post parcel shall be transmitted by air:

Provided that speed post parcel may be transmitted by surface routes where it is determined to be faster than transmission by air:

Provided further that speed post parcel, if transmitted by surface, shall be prioritised over India post parcel at every stage of transmission; and

(b) any speed post parcel presented at the window shall have the inscription "Speed Post Parcel" on it with such value additions as may be paid for, by the sender.

Speed Post Parcel — Tariff (Table IV), in force from 1 August 2026.

The earlier distance-based Speed Post Parcel tariff is replaced by a **zone-based** structure by the Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (S.O. 4241(E) dated 31.07.2026).

Speed Post Parcel — Retail

Weight Slab	Local	Within State	Zone / Metro	Other States
Up to 500 g	28	76	82	90
501 – 1000 g	48	101	137	143
1001 – 1500 g	60	130	182	228
1501 – 2000 g	87	178	254	319
2001 – 3000 g	116	243	355	450

Weight Slab	Local	Within State	Zone / Metro	Other States
3001 – 4000 g	145	298	441	560
4001 – 5000 g	174	361	539	686
Additional 1 kg	35	60	95	120

Speed Post Parcel – Contractual

Weight Slab	Local	Within State	Zone / Metro	Other States
Up to 500 g	28	36	40	47
501 – 1000 g	31	49	65	71
1001 – 1500 g	36	64	110	150
1501 – 2000 g	45	89	140	190
2001 – 3000 g	57	111	190	250
3001 – 4000 g	69	133	235	305
4001 – 5000 g	81	156	275	350
Additional 1 kg	15	25	60	65

(Tariff in ₹. GST levied as applicable. Zone/Metro categorisation as under regulation 96A above.)

101. Direct post.

(1) Direct post shall be an un-addressed mail, comprising of unaddressed items like letters, cards, brochures, questionnaires, pamphlets, samples, promotional items, coupons, posters, mailers or any other form of printed communication that is not prohibited by the Act or these regulations.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this regulation, "mail" means printed matter usually carrying a sales message or announcement, designed to elicit a response from a carefully selected consumer or business market.

Condition of articles: Minimum quantity — 1000 · Paper size — A3

(2) These items shall be accepted in bulk in designated post office and shall not be posted in a letter box.

(3) In case of items meant for delivery in other towns, direct post items shall be accepted in Postal Index Number (PIN) Code wise bundles.

(5) The rates chargeable on direct post are mentioned in Table.

Postage on Direct Post

DIRECT POST

Weight Slab	Local Rate	Inter-City Rate
First 20 grams	Rs. 1.50	Rs. 2.00
Every additional 20 grams or part thereof	Rs. 1	Rs. 1

102. Media post.

(1) Media post shall be an advertising mechanism designed to help the Central Government or State Government and corporate clients for promoting their products and services as it offers a range of advertising mediums such as postal stationery and postal premises.

(2) The advertisement shall be displayed at the area identified for advertisement in the premises of the post office.

(3) Quantity Requirement:

Medium	Minimum Quantity
Post Card	5 Lakh
Envelopes	10 Lakh
ILC	10 Lakh
Saving Bank Passbook	1 Lakh
Posters/Banners/Flex boards	10,000
Letter Boxes	100 in any area/town
MPCM Receipts	50 Lakh
Hoardings	Not Required
MMS	Not Required

Agency Commission: Accredited Agencies are eligible for 15% commission, non-accredited agencies for 10% and individual for 5% on the media plan value.

(4) The rates chargeable under media post are mentioned in Table.

MEDIA POST

Media	Rate (per piece)	Advertisement space (in cms)
Post Card	Single Colour: 10 paise	9 x 6.5 Cm

Media	Rate (per piece)	Advertisement space (in cms)
	Multi Colour: 20 paise	
Letter Card	Single Colour: 15 paise Multi Colour: 30 paise	9 x 2.5 Cm
Aerogramme	Single Colour: 20 paise Multi Colour: 40 paise	4 x 5.5 Cm
Envelopes	30 paise	9 x 2.5 Cm
Money Order Forms	10 paise	2 x 4.25 Cm
Post Office Saving Bank Passbook	10 paise	Back Cover of Passbook

103. e-Post.

(1) e-Post provides facility to send a message to any address in India with a combination of electronic transmission and physical delivery through a network of post offices.

(2) e-Post sends messages as a soft copy through internet and at the destination, it will be delivered to the addressee in the form of hard copy as an unaccountable letter item.

(3) This facility is available for retail as well as for bulk customers:

Provided that bulk customers shall enter into an agreement with the concerned authority of the Post Office for availing the e-Post facility.

- Bill will be generated by system at the end of month and paid by customer on or before the **last business day** of the following month.
- **Penalty:** if bill is not paid within the specified time penalty @ **12% per annum** on outstanding amount will be charged subject to a minimum **Rs.100/-**. If payment is not received for **two consecutive months**, the e-post service will be suspended for the corporate customer and the outstanding amount will be recovered from Bank Guarantee.
- Multiple language support - **11 languages** are available (Hindi, Tamil, Malayalam, Odia, English, Assamese, Gujarati, Konkani, Sanskrit, Marathi, Manipuri).
- **Recharge Validity: One Year** from date of recharge. If unused, the wallet must be recharged again before expiry date to maintain validity. If not recharged in a year the wallet amount will be reset zero.
- **Preservation of record of ePOST:** Record of ePOST will be preserved for **12 months**.

104. e-Payment.

(1) e-Payment provides the services of collection of bill amount or other payments for third party through post offices by entering into an agreement with the concerned authority of the Post Office.

(2) The operational conditions and fee relating to e-Payment shall be such as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

105. Retail post.

(1) Retail post shall provide the sale of departmental and third party products or services with an aim to provide convenience to the general public by making these products or services available in their vicinity through post offices.

(2) Departmental products or services shall be such as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(3) The third party products or services shall be offered through entering into an agreement with the concerned public sector and private sector entities.

(4) The Circle Head is authorised to enter into an agreement with the concerned public sector and private sector entities on behalf of the Post Office. The period of agreement will be three years initially and later it can be extended based on mutual understanding between client and department.

(5) The charges on services to be provided under the retail post shall be such as may be specified by administrative instructions by the Post Office after taking into consideration the aspects of the service to be provided.

(6) The Operational conditions for retail post shall be such as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

106. Magazine post.

(1) Any publication may be transmitted by post as 'magazine post', if it is -

(a) covered under the definition of the term "periodical" under the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023);

(b) brought out, printed, or published in India only;

(c) registered with the Press Registrar of General of India under the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023) and possesses the certificate of registration allotted by the Press Registrar of General;

(d) adhere with the provisions of the Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (51 of 2023);

(e) have a bonafide list of at least 500 subscribers; and

(f) posted with minimum 500 copies at a time.

(2) Every magazine post shall be delivered to the address mentioned on the post as an accountable item.

(3) The facilities of cash payment, Book Now Pay Later (BNPL) and advance payment may be availed by the customer for payment of postage chargeable on the periodicals under the magazine post.

(4) Registration - In the office of Divisional Head (Postal/RMS) with following documents:

(a) two copies of the latest issue of the magazine;

(b) a certificate from the District Presidency or Sub-Divisional Magistrate confirming compliance with declaration requirement of the Press and Registration of Book Act 1867.

(5) The initial Registration will remain in force until December 31 of the third calendar year following the year it was registered.

(6) Renewal - Application must be submitted at least one month before the expiration date. No fee is required for renewal however a late fee of Rs.5 will be apply for application received after the last working day of the month preceding the expiration. Late renewal applications will be treated as fresh applications.

(7) Booking -

(a) Magazine Post must be booked from Press Sorting Office (PSO) L1 or L2 unregistered offices.

(b) The magazine post must display both registration number issued by PRGI (Press Registrar General of India) and registration number issued by the Department of Posts.

(c) A special series of barcodes starting with prefix MP will be provided to publishers.

(d) Only One Magazine is allowed in one envelope.

(e) Mobile number mention with address is mandatory of all subscriber.

(8) Payment -

(a) The following method can be chosen for payment.

(i) Advance Payment: A minimum deposit of Rs. 1000 is required for single booking location and Rs. 10000 for multiple booking location. Booking is limited to amount available in Advance deposit.

(ii) Credit Facility: A BNPL user id is provided to post magazines from identified locations. A security deposit of two billing cycle in the form of bank Guarantee.

(9) Billing:

- Monthly Billing will be conducted by Post Office.
- Bills will be raised by **7th day** of the following month and payment must be made by the **last day** of that month.
- A penalty of **10% per annum** for defaulting customers after one month from the due date until all dues are cleared.
- Non-payment after two months will lead to forfeiture of the security deposit.

(10) Delivery - Magazine post will be delivered to address specified on the post as accountable items.

Maximum weight of Booking - 5 KG

Rates for Magazine Post

Sl. No.	Description	Up to 200 grams	For every additional 100 grams or part thereof
(i)	For magazines to be delivered outside the municipal area of the posting locations	Rs 12/-	Rs. 3/-
(ii)	For magazines to be delivered within the municipal area of the posting locations	Rs 8/-	Rs. 3/-

CHAPTER VI

INTERNATIONAL ITEMS AND SERVICES

107. International post.

(1) In the international post, letter post shall include items such as letters, postcards, aerogramme, printed papers (including books and registered newspapers, small packets, literature for the blind, M Bag (Bulk Bag), and International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS).

(2) In the international post, "parcel post" shall include items such as international air parcel, international surface airlifted parcels (SAL) and international surface parcels.

(3) Express Mail Service (EMS) shall be the fastest service for sending documents and merchandise worldwide.

A. LETTER POST ITEMS

108. Letters (International).

(1) Letter, which may contain a communication enclosed in an envelope and addressed with a weight limit up to 2 kgs, may be transmitted to or from addressees or senders in foreign countries or territories.

(2) Letters shall conform to the following maximum and minimum dimensions, namely:-

(a) maximum dimensions: length, width and depth combined: 900 mm, but the greatest dimension may not exceed 600 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm;

- in roll form: length plus twice the diameter: 1,040 mm, but the greatest dimension may not exceed 900 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm;

(b) minimum dimensions: surface measuring not less than 90 x 140 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm;

- in roll form: length plus twice the diameter: 170 mm: but the greatest dimension may not be less than 100 mm.

(3) The rates of postage chargeable on letters (International) are mentioned as under -

Basic Tariff for Air Letter-Post Items

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Letters	USA	Upto First 20gms	32.00

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
			For every additional 20gms or thereof upto 2000 gms	22.00
		For all countries except USA	Upto First 20gms	25.00
			For every additional 20gms or thereof upto 2000 gms	15.00

109. Aerogramme.

(1) Aerogramme which is a priority item consisting of a sheet of paper suitably folded and gummed on all sides, shall be transmitted exclusively by air to or from addressees or senders in foreign countries or territories.

(2) Aerogramme shall be sold by the post offices specified by the Circle Head:

Provided that privately manufactured aerogramme shall not be transmitted by post.

(3) Aerogramme shall conform to the following maximum and minimum dimensions, namely:-

(a) the maximum size of an aerogramme shall not exceed 110 X 220 mm when folded and, in that form, its length shall be equal to or greater than its width multiplied by $\sqrt{2}$ (Approximate value: 1.4);

(b) the minimum size permissible for folded aerogrammes shall be same as for letters, i.e. 90 X 140 mm.

(4) The rates of postage chargeable on aerogramme shall be mentioned as under -

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Aerogramme	For all countries	Maximum 3 gms	20.00

110. Post card (International).

(1) Postcard is an open communication transmitted by surface, on a sheet of paper with maximum dimensions of 120 x 235 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm, provided they are sufficiently stiff to withstand processing without difficulties; and with minimum dimensions of 90 x 140 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm.

(2) Postcards, either issued by the Post Offices or manufactured privately shall be accepted for transmission to foreign countries or territory:

Provided that privately manufactured postcards shall be rectangular and be made of material and dimensions similar to those used for the postcards issued by the Post Office.

(3) The rates of postage chargeable on postcard (International) shall be mentioned as under -

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Post Card (Single)	Pakistan, Nepal, Bangladesh and Bhutan		8.00
		APPU Countries (except Pakistan, Nepal, Bangladesh and Bhutan)		10.00
		UPU Countries (Except APPU)		12.00

111. Airmail Postcard.

(1) Airmail postcard is a postcard which is transmitted by air.

(2) The provisions of postcard as mentioned in sub-regulation (1) and (2) of regulation 110 shall be applicable to airmail postcard.

(3) The rates of postage chargeable on airmail postcard shall be mentioned as under -

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Airmail Post Card	Pakistan, Nepal, Bangladesh and Bhutan		10.00
		Other Countries		15.00

△ Currency note (verify against the gazette). The **Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations, 2025** (notified 30.12.2025, in force 1 January 2026) reportedly **omitted** “small packets” from several regulations (including 22, 107, 112, 128, 138 and 143) and from Schedules III & IV, and revised regulation 107 so that “parcel post” includes international air parcels. The primary text of that amendment was **not available** while these notes were compiled; the regulation 112 text below is reproduced from the 2024 Regulations and should be **checked against the latest gazette** before it is relied upon.

112. Small packet.

(1) Letter post items which contain small quantities of goods such as gifts, items of saleable value, and samples of merchandise, may be transmitted by post, as small packets.

(2) Small packets shall not bear any inscriptions or contain documents in the nature of current and personal correspondence or any document exchanged between persons other than the sender and the addressee.

(3) Small packets shall conform to the following maximum and minimum dimensions and prescribed for letters, namely:-

(a) maximum dimensions: length, width and depth combined: 900 mm, but the greatest dimension may not exceed 600 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm;

- in roll form: length plus twice the diameter: 1,040 mm, but the greatest dimension may not exceed 900 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm;

(b) minimum dimensions: to have a surface measuring not less than 90 x 140 mm, with a tolerance of 2 mm;

- in roll form: length plus twice the diameter: 170 mm: but the greatest dimension may not be less than 100 mm

(4) Small packets shall have maximum weight upto 2 kg and minimum weight of 100 gms.

(5) The rates of postage chargeable on small packets are mentioned as under -

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Small Packets	USA	Upto First 100gms	115.00
			For every additional 100gms and part thereof upto 2000gms	105.00
		For all countries except USA	Upto First 100gms	80.00
			For every additional 100gms and part thereof upto 2000gms	70.00

113. Printed papers.

(1) Letter post items which contain only newspapers, may be transmitted by post as printed papers.

(2) Several printed papers may be sent together in a single item provided that they shall not bear the names and addresses of different addressees.

(3) Printed papers shall be made up in such a way that their contents are sufficiently protected while permitting quick and easy verification.

(4) Printed papers shall have a maximum weight upto 2 kg and a minimum weight of 20 gms.

(5) The rates of postage chargeable on printed papers are mentioned as under -

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Printed Papers	USA	Upto First 20gms	35.00
			For every additional 20gms or thereof upto 2000 gms	25.00
		For all countries except USA	Upto First 20gms	27.00
			For every additional 20gms or thereof upto 2000 gms	17.00

114. M-Bag (Bulk bag).

(1) M-Bag (Bulk bag) are special bags containing printed papers, newspapers, periodicals, books and similar printed documentation for the same addressee at the same address marked with the inscription "M" intended for transmission to or from addresses or senders in foreign countries or territory.

(2) The maximum permissible weight of an M-bag is 30 kg.

(3) Each M-Bag should be accompanied by Form CN22 or Form CN23 prepared by the sender;

Explanation.- For the purposes of this sub-regulation, "Form CN22" or "Form CN23" means the relevant forms specified in this behalf by the Universal Postal Union.

(4) Every M-Bag shall be furnished with a rectangular address label provided by the sender and providing all the information concerning the addressee and the address label shall be made of sufficiently rigid material and shall not measure more than 90mm X 140mm.

(5) The postage paid for the M-Bag shall be shown on the address label of the bag and the weight limits for M-Bags shall be up to 30 kg, which is subject to the maximum acceptable weight limit specified by the country or territory of destination, whichever is lower

(6) M-Bags may also contain other contents as under:

(a) the contents (commercial samples shipped by manufacturers and distributors, or other non- dutiable commercial items or informational materials that are not subject to resale) are as list affixed to or otherwise combined with the accompanying printed papers;

(b) the contents relate exclusively to the printed papers with which they are being mailed;

(7) The rates of postage chargeable on M-Bag are mentioned as under -

Sr. No	Name of Product	Name of the Country	Weight Slab	Rate (in Rupees)
1	Mail Bag	For all countries	For a weight not exceeding 5 Kg	700.00
			Per Kg. or part exceeding 5 Kg. up to 30 Kg	150.00

115. Literature for blind (International).

(1) Papers of any kind (including letters), periodicals, books and plates impressed in "braille" or any other special type for the use of the blind may be transmitted as literature for the blind (blind literature).

(2) Sound records shall be admitted for transmission as literature for the blind only if these are sent by, or addressed to, an officially recognised institute for the blind and a list of such institutions in India shall be published from time to time.

(3) The maximum weight for the blind literature shall be upto 7 kg.

(4) The literature for the blind shall be exempted from postage but surface airlift or air surcharge may be availed by paying the applicable fee.

116. International tracked packet service (ITPS).

(1) The Circle Head is authorised to specify, from time to time, the offices where the item called as international tracked packet may be booked subject to the following conditions, namely: -

(a) the maximum weight of an international tracked packet shall be 2 kg, provided that the said limit may be amended from time to time

(b) the sum of the length, width and depth shall not exceed 90 cm and the largest dimension shall not exceed 60 cm.

(2) An international tracked packet shall be booked, transmitted and delivered in the manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(3) The discount and value additions to the customers for international tracked packet shall be provided in the manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE:** **International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS)** rates were revised significantly to boost exports (especially for e-commerce) vide notifications in **2025**, with reduced rates for key destinations. ITPS is now available for **45+ countries** including USA, UK, Canada, Australia, etc.

B. PARCEL POST ITEMS

117. International air parcel.

(1) International air parcel provides economical and faster mode of transmission of documents and merchandise to all the Universal Postal Union member countries with track and trace facility.

(2) International air parcel may be booked in the post offices as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time, subject to the following conditions, namely: -

(a) the maximum gross weight of an international air parcel shall be 20 kg, subject to the maximum acceptable weight limit specified by the country or territory of destination, whichever is lower or as amended from time to time;

(b) the maximum dimension shall not exceed 1.5 metre or 3 meters for the sum of the length and the greatest circumference measured in a direction other than that of length.

(3) No international air parcel shall be smaller than the minimum size prescribed for letters i.e. 90 mm X 140 mm.

(4) An international air parcel shall be booked, transmitted, and delivered in the manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

C. INTERNATIONAL SPEED POST SERVICES (EMS)

118. International speed post.

(1) International speed post, globally known as Express Mail Service (EMS), is a postal express service for transmission of documents and merchandise, and shall be the best possible quickest postal service by physical means.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this sub-regulation:-

(a) "documents" includes documents of any kind containing information or data in alphabetical, numerical or technical form, which are not dutiable or saleable; and

(b) "merchandise" includes any article or thing, other than documents transmissible by post, the insurance of which is not compulsory.

(2) International speed post items (EMS) may be booked from all the post offices across the country.

(3) International Speed Post (EMS) may be availed subject to the following conditions, namely:-

(a) the maximum gross weight of an international speed post shall be 35 Kg, which is subject to the maximum acceptable weight limit prescribed by the country or territory of destination, whichever is lower or as amended from time to time;

Provided that the higher limit of weight of an international speed post service addressed to or from any other country or territory may be such as may be specified by administrative instructions;

(b) the size of an item for international speed post service shall not exceed 1.5 meter for any one dimension and 3 meters for the sum of the length and the greatest circumference measured in a direction other than the length;

(c) discount and value additions to the customers for international speed post shall be provided as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time;

(d) an international speed post (EMS) shall be booked, transmitted and delivered in the manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time;

(e) precious metals (including gold, silver, platinum or other precious metals), precious stones (including diamond or other precious stones), jewellery or any combination of these whether manufactured or not, coins, bank notes, currency notes, securities of any kind payable to bearer, travellers' cheques, shall be transmitted by insured Express Mail Service, and the value of such insurance shall not exceed 1,00,000;

Provided that the higher value of insurance may be specified in respect of any such item.

D. COMMON REGULATIONS RELATED WITH INTERNATIONAL MAILES

119. Booking.

- (1) The postage payable for international items are as mentioned in Schedule III.
- (2) The postage, special fee and air surcharges may be refunded to the sender in the event of suspension of services.

120. Electronic advance data (EAD).

- (1) Items containing goods may be subject to specific import customs and security based requirements for providing electronic advance data at the country or territory of destination.
- (2) The exchange of electronic advance data may be additionally governed by bilateral or multilateral agreements or protocols regarding the protection of personal data and other technical aspects relating to data exchanges.
- (3) Each item for which electronic advance data is provided shall be accompanied by the appropriate customs declaration Form CN22 or Form CN23:-
 - (a) CN 22- if the declared value of the international items less than or equal to 300 Special Drawing Rights (SDR);
 - (b) CN 23-If the declared value of the international items is greater than 300 Special Drawing Rights (SDR), a CN 23 shall also be provided.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this sub-regulation, "Form CN22" or "Form CN23" means the relevant forms specified in this behalf by the Universal Postal Union.

- (4) The sender of international mail is required to provide Know Your Customer (KYC) documents or electronic Know Your Customer (eKYC) documents for the booking of international mail containing merchandise.
- (5) The electronic advance data necessary to meet the requirements under this regulation shall, in all cases, replicate data documented on the appropriate Universal Postal Union customs declaration form.
- (6) Letters, postcards, printed papers (other than books) or letter-post items containing correspondence or items for the blind, which are not subject to customs duties, shall be exempted from electronic advance data requirements.

(7) Electronic advance data adoption requires mandatory submission of the following data elements, known as the 7+1 dataset to comply with required regulatory and security requirements:

- (a) Consignor name
- (b) Consignor address
- (c) Consignee name
- (d) Consignee address
- (e) Number of packages
- (f) Total gross weight (including measure unit qualifier)
- (g) Brief merchandise or cargo description
- (h) Identifier

121. Packaging.

- (1) All items shall be made up securely and in such a way that there is no risk of other items getting trapped in the item and the packaging shall adapt to the shape, nature of the item and the condition of transport.
- (2) Every item shall be made up in such a way as not to affect the health of officials and so as not to present any danger, if it contains items of a kind likely to injure the officials called upon to handle it or soil or damage other items or postal equipment.
- (3) The detailed conditions of packaging for international items including value added services, shall be as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

122. Delivery in country or territory of destination.

- (1) Items shall be delivered in the country or territory of destination in accordance with their relevant laws or internal regulations.
- (2) The Post Office shall not be responsible for the manner in which an item is delivered or returned undelivered, if it is done in accordance with the relevant laws or internal regulations of the country or territory of destination.
- (3) The period of detention of undeliverable items shall also be governed by the relevant laws or internal regulations of the country or territory of destination.

E. OTHER FEATURES OF INTERNATIONAL MAIL ITEMS

123. Other features.

Any outward accountable item shall be presented to the post office and a receipt shall be given to the person who presents such item.

124. Track and trace service.

For every accountable international item, electronic exchange of data is available at item level, receptacle level and airlines level to facilitate transparency in the movement of items and receptacles, however, for registered letter items, this service is not available for some of the destination as per the internal regulations of destination.

125. Inward international mails.

(1) The conditions for transmission of items by post shall be as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

Provided that the regulations relating to domestic registered newspapers shall be deemed to apply in the case of newspapers sent to any foreign country or territory.

(2) Any inward accountable item shall not be delivered to the addressee unless and until an authorised person has signed a receipt for it.

126. Failure to take delivery.

(1) If the addressee of an international air parcel fails to take delivery of it within seven days, following the date of its first presentation or the date of delivery to him or to the authorised person of an intimation of its arrival, a demurrage charges, commencing from the eighth day, shall be collected from the addressee at the time of delivery:

Provided that in the case of an international air parcel, bearing an alternate address, if the parcel cannot be delivered at the original address, the demurrage charge due from the first addressee shall also be collected from the second addressee at the time of delivery.

(2) If the addressee of-

- (a) an inward international packet (or bag) or printed papers;
- (b) an inward International small packet; or
- (c) an inward International insured letter or insured box

fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its first presentation or the date of delivery to him or to his authorised person of an intimation of its arrival, and if its

weighs more than 500 grams, a demurrage charge commencing from the eighth day, shall be collected from the addressee at the time of delivery.

(3) The demurrage charges as referred in sub-regulations (1) and (2), shall be as mentioned as under –

Demurrage charges for international air parcel

S. No.	Description	Demurrage charges
1	Demurrage charges, commencing from the eighth day, to be collected from the addressee, in case, the addressee of an international air parcel fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its first presentation or the date of delivery to him or to his accredited agent of an intimation of its arrival	Rupee one per day (subject to maximum of twenty four rupees and fifty paise)
2	Demurrage charges, commencing from the eighth day, to be collected from the addressee, in case, the addressee of an international air parcel, addressed "Poste Restante" fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its first presentation or the date of delivery to him or to his accredited agent of an intimation of its arrival	Rupees one per day (subject to maximum of forty rupees)
3	Demurrage charge, commencing from the eighth day, to be collected from the addressee at the time of delivery, if the addressee of (a) an inward international packet (or bag) or printed papers or (b) an inward international small packet or (c) an inward international insured letter or insured box, fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its first presentation or the date of delivery to him or to his accredited agent of an intimation of its arrival, and if it weighs more than 500 grams	Rupees ten per day
4	Demurrage charge, commencing from the eighth day, to be collected from the addressee at the time of delivery, if the addressee of (a) an inward international packet (or bag) or printed papers, or (b) an inward international small packet, or (c) an inward international insured letter or insured box, addressed "Poste Restante" fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its arrival in the office of delivery, and if it weighs more than 500 grams	Rupees ten per day

127. Failure to take delivery of Post Restante parcel.

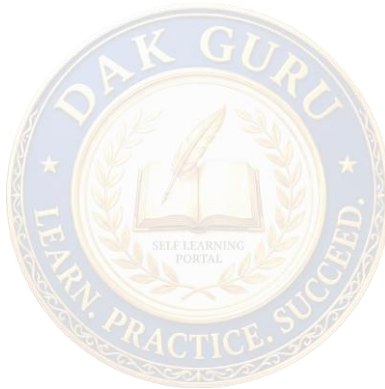
(1) If the addressee of an international air parcel addressed "Poste Restante" fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its arrival in the office of delivery, a

demurrage charge, commencing from the eighth day, shall be collected from the addressee at the time of delivery.

(2) If the addressee of -

- (a) an inward international packet (or bag) of printed papers; or
- (b) an inward International small packet; or
- (c) an inward International insured letter or insured box,

addressed "Poste Restante" fails to take delivery of it within seven days following the date of its arrival in the office of delivery, and if it weighs more than 500 grams, commencing from the eighth day shall be collected from the addressee at the time of delivery.



CHAPTER VII

UNIVERSAL POSTAL SERVICE

128. Mail services under Universal Postal Service.

The Post Office shall offer the following products of mails services under the Universal Postal Services, namely: -

(a) Domestic:

- (i) Letters
- (ii) Letter card
- (iii) Book Post
- (iv) Periodical Post
- (v) Registered Newspaper
- (vi) Literature for Blind
- (vii) India Post Parcel
- (viii) Post Card

(b) International:

- (i) Letters
- (ii) Aerogramme
- (iii) Post Card
- (iv) Airmail Post Card
- (v) Small Packet
- (vi) Printed Papers
- (vii) Literature for Blind
- (viii) International Air Parcel



CHAPTER VIII

OFFICIAL CORRESPONDENCE

129. On postal service.

Items of any class on the service of the Post Office by officers of the Post Office, Posts Audit Officers and such other officers, as may be authorised in this behalf, shall be transmitted **free of postage** and all other postal fees.

130. (1) The following items may be insured "On Postal Service", namely: -

- (a) items having intrinsic value;
- (b) important documents such as service book, Annual Performance Assessment Report (APAR) file, Official files, etc.;
- (c) documents related to investigation, vigilance cases, examination etc.; and
- (d) other important documents deemed fit to be sent as Insured Items.

(2) The following items shall be registered "On Postal Service", namely: -

- (a) important official documents- Annual Performance Assessment Report (APAR), etc.;
 - (b) items required to be sent through registered post such as charge sheets, etc.; and
 - (c) other important documents deemed fit to be sent as registered items.
- (3) "On Postal service" shall not be available for items posted under speed post.

131. Postal ballot or election material.

(1) The election material tendered by the Election Commission of India or the State Election Commission shall be booked, transmitted and delivered in accordance with the procedure as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) The provisions of sub-regulation (1) shall be equally applicable to postal ballots.

(3) Every item referred to in sub-regulations (1) and (2) shall be deemed to be an official item for the purposes of this regulation and given priority accordingly.

CHAPTER IX

VALUE ADDED SERVICES

A. DOMESTIC ITEMS

132. ~~Registration of domestic items.~~ (Omitted)

This regulation, which previously governed the standalone "Registered Post" service, has been **omitted**. This legally formalizes the "abolition" of Registered Post as a separate product.

Effective **September 1, 2025**, the standalone **Registered Post** service for domestic transmission has been discontinued and merged with **Speed Post**. Users requiring secure, recorded delivery must now use Speed Post (with optional registration value-added service).

133. Insurance of domestic items.

(1) Any accountable item, shall be insured for the value not exceeding **one lakh rupees** at identified booking centres or post offices and on payment of such fee as mentioned as under

-

INSURANCE FEE (DOMESTIC)

In addition to the postage and the fee for registration, the further fees chargeable for insurance is as under:

Category	Value	Fee
(i) For insurance of Speed Post parcels:		
(a)	Insured value upto ₹200	₹10
(b)	Insured value above ₹200	₹10 + ₹6 for every additional ₹100 or fraction thereof
(ii) For insurance of Items other than Speed Post Parcels:		
(a)	When the value insured does not exceed ₹200/-	₹10/-
(b)	For every additional ₹100/- or fraction thereof in excess of ₹200/-	₹6/-

(2) Where currency or bank notes are dispatched by insured post, the value shall not exceed twenty thousand rupees.

Provided that in no case such value shall exceed the real value of the contents of the item insured:

Provided further that items containing precious metals (including gold, silver, platinum or other precious metals), precious stones (including diamond or other precious stones), jewellery or any combination of these in conformity with the definitions in the applicable law of the land for the time being in force or other valuable contents, shall be insured and for the actual value of the contents.

(3) Insurance service may also be provided by the Post Office through a third-party insurance provider as may be specified by administrative instructions.

(4) The sender shall declare on the item, the actual value of the contents at the time of booking of the item.

(5) Items to which the insurance system is applicable shall be those which contain bank notes, currency notes, bonds, coupons, securities, parcels containing valuables, and other documents of the kind.

(6) Documents of value such as deeds, plans, contracts, autographs, rare manuscripts, may also be sent by insured post, provided that where documents have value by reason of the cost of their preparation, the insured value may not exceed the cost of replacing them in case of loss limited to the maximum limit of Post Office.

(7) Insurance shall cover all risks, except acts of God, or occurrences such as war, riots, civil commotions, arrest or restrained or seizure under legal process, order, restriction or any prohibition imposed by the Central Government, in the course of transmission by post.

(8) The sender of an insured item under this regulation shall be entitled to obtain free of charge a proof of delivery of its delivery signed by the addressee or authorised person:

Provided further that in case, if the proof of delivery does not reach the sender of the registered item, then a certificate of delivery shall be issued by Post Master or officer-in-charge of the delivery post office, on demand of the customer and shall be given to the sender in electronic form.

(9) Items containing any of the following items may not be insured against damage, but they may be insured against loss only, on payment of fees on the same scale as those for insurance of other items against loss or damage, that is to say, liquids and substances which easily liquefy, perishable items and fragile items, such as, china glassware, millinery, gramophone records, etc.

(10) The sender of an item may waive his claim to compensation in favour of the addressee.

(11) The detailed conditions of packaging for insured items shall be as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(12) Compensation in respect of insured items shall be payable as mentioned in regulation 74.

134. Airmail service.

Items intended to be posted for transmission by air, shall be charged an airmail fee, in addition to the postage and other fee payable under the regulations, as mentioned as under:

Air Mail fee (Domestic)

Air mail fee chargeable in addition to the postage and other fee payable on items posted for transmission by air at any post office in India:

- ₹ 2/- for the first **fifty grams** or fraction thereof, and
- ₹ 1/- for every additional **fifty grams** or fraction thereof.

135. Cash on delivery (COD) items.

(1) Cash on delivery shall be made available by the Post Office for a fee as mentioned in following table, where an amount is to be recovered from addressee on delivery of such item and shall be remitted to the sender in the manner as may be specified by administrative instructions.

(2) Cash on delivery may be availed for items, subject to the following conditions, namely: -

(a) retail customers and customers shall sign an agreement with the concerned authority of the Post Office;

(b) the amount specified for recovery from addressee shall be as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time;

(c) such items do not contain any prohibited items; and

(d) insurance of Cash on Delivery items may be availed by sender.

136. Proof of delivery.

(1) The sender of any domestic accountable item may request for a proof of delivery, which shall be provided to him or her on delivery of the item on payment of fees as mentioned in the following Table in addition to the postage or fees for any other value-added service.

A new regulation was added to introduce OTP-based delivery as a formal value-added service.

PROOF OF DELIVERY

- Fee payable on proof of delivery of items: **Rupees ten** per item in addition to postage and other applicable fee.

(2) The proof of delivery, shall be signed in ink by the addressee or an authorised person, or if the addressee refuses to so sign, shall be accompanied by statement to the effect that the addressee or his duly authorised person has refused to so sign:

Provided that the Director General may specify by administrative instructions other means of recording proof of delivery and sharing the same with the sender.

(3) In case of a physical proof of delivery, the same shall be processed as an accountable item.

(4) The sender may obtain an attested copy of the original receipt on payment of prescribed fee, in a manner as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time: Provided that no such fee shall be charged on blind literature item.

137. Services relating to pre-mailing activities.

Every post office shall provide pre-mailing activities, which may include printing, collection, addressing and franking on various items as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time and at the rates mentioned in **Table V of Schedule IV**.

B. INTERNATIONAL ITEMS

138. Registration of international items.

(1) Letters, post cards, small packets, printed papers, aerogrammes, literature for the blind and M-Bag may be registered at any post office for transmission to countries or territories and places served by the Post Office, subject to such exceptions as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) Provisions relating to the registration of domestic items, shall be equally applicable to registered items sent or received by the foreign post.

(3) In addition to the postage, a fee shall be charged for the registration of the international items.

Provided that no fees shall be payable for the registration of a blind literature packet.

139. Insurance of International items.

(1) International letter post, parcel post and express mail service items may be insured at any post office:

Provided that letter post item tendered for insurance, not required to be registered.

(3) Insurance service may also be provided by the Post Office through a third-party insurance provider as may be specified by administrative instructions.

140. International items with precious metals.

(1) An item containing precious metals (including gold, silver, platinum or other precious metals), precious stones (including diamond or other precious stones), jewellery or any combination of these, whether manufactured or not, coins, bank notes, currency notes, securities of any kind payable to bearer, travellers' cheques, except as otherwise specified by administrative instructions, shall not be accepted for transmission by post, unless the sender also agrees to insure it at the actual value of the content, as specified by administrative instructions.

(2) Where an international insured letter post, parcel post, or express mail service item containing objects as mentioned in sub-regulation (1), is addressed to a country or territory where insurance is not available, such items shall be insured for its domestic transit within the limits of India for the actual value of the content.

(3) If an uninsured international item, declared to contain or manifestly containing any of the objects of the value specified in sub-regulation (1), is received from a foreign country or territory, the parcel shall be forwarded to the destination and delivered to the addressee subject to the payment of a fee for insurance on the declared value of the contents, or on the value assessed by the customs authorities, whichever is higher:

Provided that such item is refused by the addressee, it shall be returned to the country or territory of origin.

141. Redirected or returned international item.

Where an insured international parcel, which has been redirected or returned as undeliverable, is received in India subject to a fresh insurance fee by reason of its having been so redirected or returned, such fee shall be recoverable on delivery, as if it were postage due.

142. Compensation payable.

(1) When an international letter post or parcel post, has been posted in and insured by the post office and when such letter or parcel has been lost, or the contents thereof have abstracted or damaged in the course of transmission by post, compensation not exceeding the amount for which such letter or parcel has been insured, shall be payable to the sender

except in the case of a parcel in respect of which the administration of the country or territory of destination decides to pay compensation to the addressee under the same:

Provided that no compensation shall be paid in respect of letter post, parcel post or express mail service item sent by or addressed to -

(a) a prisoner of war, either directly or through a National Information Bureau or Central Information Agency referred to in Geneva Convention of the 12th August, 1949, relating to the treatment of prisoners of war;

(b) a belligerent, received and interned in a neutral country;

(c) a civilian internee, as defined in the Geneva Convention of the 12th August, 1949, relating to the protection of civilian persons in time of war, either directly or through a National Information Bureau or in Central Information Agency referred to in that Convention; and

(d) a National Information Bureau or a Central Information Agency regarding prisoners of war.

(2) Whenever an addressee has made reservations at the time of taking delivery of letter post, parcel post or express mail service items, the contents of which have been abstracted or damaged, or has, after taking delivery thereof, immediately made a complaint of abstraction or damage to the administration of the office of delivery and proved that the abstraction or damage did not take place after the delivery, the compensation payable shall be payable to the sender and no claim for the payment of compensation to the addressee shall be entertained.

(3) When a letter post, parcel post or an express mail service item insured by a foreign administration is lost, or the contents thereof are abstracted or damaged, compensation shall be payable by the Indian Post Office to the addressee up to an amount not exceeding that for which it has been insured, if he claims such compensation after having made reservation in taking delivery and if he furnished proof that the sender has waived his rights to such compensation in favour of the addressee.

(4) The compensation payable, in no case, exceeds actual value of the item, insured value, or amount of loss occasioned by the abstraction of, or damage to, the contents of the item, whichever is lower and any resultant loss of profits or other indirect loss shall not be taken into consideration in the assessment of such compensation.

143. Surface airlift and air surcharge.

(1) Letters, small packets, printed paper, literature for the blind, post card, and M-bag may be accepted at any post office for transmission

(a) by surface airlifted, subject to such exceptions as may be specified by administrative instructions, on payment of fee for surface airlift as mentioned in following Table

(b) by air, subject to such exceptions as may be specified by administrative instructions, on payment of fee for air surcharge as mentioned in above Table.

(2) The fee specified in sub-regulation (1) shall be chargeable in addition to the postage and other applicable fee or charges.

144. Advice of delivery.

(1) The sender of a registered letter-post item, international air parcel, insured item, or express mail service item posted in India and addressed to any country or territory shall be entitled to apply for advice of delivery in the **form CN 07** at the time of posting by paying a fee, in addition to the postage and other fee, at the rates as mentioned in following Table.

Fees for Advice of Delivery (International)

Destination	Rate
For Bhutan and Nepal	Rs. 10
For other foreign countries	Rs. 20

Explanation.- For the purposes of this sub-regulation, "Form CN07" means the relevant forms specified in this behalf by the Universal Postal Union.

(2) When the sender enquires about an advice of delivery of an item which is not received within the normal period, as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time, no fee shall be collected for inquiries and requests for information.

(3) When the sender of such item posted in India and addressed to any country or territory who is a member of Universal Postal Union, has not paid the fee for advice of delivery and desires to have an enquiry made by the Post Office regarding the disposal of item, he shall be entitled to this service without any charge.

(4) The advice of delivery of the items referred to in this regulation shall be returned to the sender by the quickest means which includes electronic exchange of advices of delivery.

CHAPTER X

MONEY REMITTANCE SERVICES

A. DOMESTIC

145. Domestic money order.

(1) Money order (MO) shall be an order issued by the Post Office for the payment of a sum of money to the person in whose name the money order is sent, by the remitter.

(2) The maximum amount for which a single money order may be issued shall not exceed ten thousand rupees and shall not include a fraction of a rupee:

Provided that total amount remitted through retail money order to a person in a month shall not exceed twenty-five thousand rupees.

(3) A commission payable on the issue of money order shall be charged at the rate as mentioned in following Table

MONEY ORDER

Commission chargeable on Money Order shall be as under: -

- For every **twenty rupees** of the amount of remittance or fraction thereof: ₹ 1

(4) The remittance of money through money order shall be made free of charge without payment of commission thereof for transmission of amount of contribution to the Prime Minister's Relief Fund, PM CARES Fund (Prime Minister's Citizen Assistance and Relief in Emergency Situation Fund) or Chief Minister's Relief Fund, or any other such fund as may be notified from time to time.

(5) Nothing in sub regulation (3) shall prevent transmission of service money order free of charge as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

146. Period of currency of money order.

The currency period of the money order shall expire upon the end of the last day of the **second month** following the month of issue.

147. Categories of money order.

The money order shall be booked under the following categories, namely:

- (a) retail money order under which money shall be remitted from a person to another person within the country;
- (b) bulk money order under which money shall be remitted in the following cases:
 - (i) where money is remitted by one person to many persons; or
 - (ii) where money is remitted from many persons to one person; and
- (c) service money order under which money shall be remitted for departmental or official purposes.

148. Booking of money order.

- (1) The money order form as specified by administrative instructions, duly filled in by the remitter, together with the amount of the money order and the commission payable and in case of money order referred to in of clause (b) of regulation 147 along with a valid identification proof, may be submitted by the remitter for availing the money order service.
- (2) A receipt shall be given to the remitter for the amount paid by him on account of the money order and the commission thereof.

149. The remitter of a money order shall be entitled to obtain, free of charge,-

- (a) an electronic intimation of the payment of the amount of the order in shape of short messaging service or any other digital mode; and
- (b) a certificate of payment on the request of the remitter, subject to such request being made within three months from the date of booking.

150. Payment of money order.

- (1) The payment of a money order shall ordinarily be made at the address of the payee -
 - (a) to the payee; or
 - (b) to any person authorised by the payee.
- (2) If the payee of a money order is a minor or illiterate, or his physical or mental condition is such rendering him incapable of providing acquittance of having received the money, then the identity of the payee for the payment shall be verified in such manner as may be specified by administrative instructions by the Director General from time to time.

151. Redirection of money order.

- (1) A money order may be redirected to another address of payee, free of charge, if the payee makes a request, as specified by administrative instructions along with the proof of identity.
- (2) No alteration in the name of payee shall be permitted in the money order.
- (3) A money order may be stopped and returned to the remitter, free of charge, if the remitter makes a request, as may be specified by administrative instructions, until the delivery post office issues it to the postman for the delivery, and in such a case, the amount of the money order, excluding the commission thereof, shall be refunded to the remitter.
- (4) In no case, the Post Office shall be responsible for inability or failure to stop payment of a money order as per remitter's request.
- (5) If the payee of a money order refuses to take payment on its presentation to him, the amount of the money order shall be returned to the remitter excluding the commission thereof:

Provided that if the payee who is unable to take payment on its presentation to him, makes an application, as may be specified by administrative instructions for retention of the money order or the payee is not found at the address given on the money order, the money order shall be retained in the post office for a period not exceeding seven days from the date of its presentation to the payee, or from the date it is sent out for payment, as the case may be, and if the payee fails to take payment of the money order from the post office within the said period of seven days, the money order shall be returned to the remitter on the first working day immediately following the expiry of the said period of seven days.

- (6) If the payee of money order is dead, the amount of the money order shall be returned to the remitter:

Provided that the remitter of money order is dead, the amount of money order shall be paid to the legal heir of the remitter, as may be specified by administrative instructions.

152. Exemption from liability of Post Office in respect of money order.

- (1) The Post Office shall not be responsible for the wrong payment of a money order by incorrect or incomplete information given by the remitter as to the name and address of the payee.
- (2) After a money order has been paid, to whosoever it is meant for payment, the Post Office shall not be liable to any further claim.

153. Undelivered Money Order.

The undelivered money order shall be returned to the remitter and the amount of the money order shall be paid to the remitter excluding the commission thereof.

154. Void money order.

When, for any reason, a money order remains unpaid, either to the payee or the remitter, at the end of the **second month** following the month of its issue, it shall be treated as void by the office of issue.

155. Forfeiture of money order amount.

The amount or value of money order unpaid beyond **three years** from the date of booking shall be forfeited and after expiry of the said period, such amount or value shall be treated as revenue to the Government of India.

156. Suspension of service.

The services of money orders by any particular post office, or group of post offices, in special circumstances, may be suspended by the Circle Head, by order in writing.

157. Postal order.

- (1) The amount for which a single postal order may be issued shall be in the denomination of ten rupees, twenty rupees, fifty rupees or one hundred rupees.
- (2) The amount for which an electronic -Indian postal order shall be issued is ten rupees.
- (3) The commission charged in respect of a postal order shall be as mentioned in Table

POSTAL ORDER

Commission chargeable on Postal Order shall be as under: -

Sl No	Value	Commission
1	For ₹ 10	₹ 1/-
2	Upto ₹ 20	₹ 2/-
3	Upto ₹ 50	₹ 5/-
4	Upto ₹ 100	₹ 10/-

(4) Broken amounts may be made up by affixing unused postage stamps, not exceeding four in number on the face of the postal orders, or where the space on that side is not adequate on the reverse thereof:

Provided that the total of stamps affixed on each order shall not exceed nine rupees and the total amount payable on the order shall not exceed one hundred rupees.

(5) The person to whom a postal order is issued shall, before parting with it, fill the name in English or any other language mentioned in Eighth Schedule to the Constitution and is recommended to fill in the name of the office of payment as a precaution against the order being lost or stolen.

(6) Even where a postal order is crossed with a view to the payment through a bank, the name of the payee shall be filled in.

158. Currency period.

(1) The postal orders presented within twenty-four months from the last day of the month of issue, are encashable without second commission.

(2) Where postal order is not presented for payment within twenty-four months from the last day of the month of issue, a second commission at the rate mentioned in Table II of Schedule V, shall be charged, which shall be paid in postage stamp affixed to the back of the postal order or through cash receipt.

159. Forfeiture.

A postal order presented beyond **thirty-six months** after the last day of the month of issue shall be forfeited and shall not be paid.

160. Repayment of postal order.

(1) The purchaser of a postal order shall, within twenty-four months from the last day of the month of issue, be entitled to obtain repayment of its value, but not the commission, on presenting the postal order and the counterfoil at the post office from which the postal order was purchased.

(2) The purchaser shall also be entitled to repayment of its value after twenty-four months but not after thirty-six months from the last day of the month of issue, provided a second commission at the rate as mentioned in Table II of Schedule V, is paid.

(3) Should the order have been crossed for payment through a bank, the purchaser shall first cancel the crossing by writing across the face of the postal order the words "please pay cash" and add his initials.

(4) After a postal order has once been paid to the payee, the Post Office shall not be liable for any further claim.

161. Payee's name essential.

A postal order shall not be paid even though presented for payment by a bank unless the name of the payee is inserted in the body of the postal order.

162. Payment through bank.

If a postal order is crossed, payment shall be made only through a bank, and if the name of the bank is added, payment shall be made only through that bank.

163. Payment of crossed postal order.

If a postal order which is crossed with or without name of the bank, is presented for payment by or through a bank, with the name of such bank written or stamped upon the face thereof, that name may be accepted as a sufficient receipt for the amount of the postal order, and the postal order may be paid without any other receipt.

164. Mutilated postal orders.

If any erasure or alteration is made, or if the postal order is cut, defaced or mutilated, payment thereof may be refused.

165. Electronic postal order.

The provisions mentioned in **sub-regulation (2) of regulation 157** and **regulations 158 and 159** shall apply *mutatis mutandis* to the electronic postal order.

B. INTERNATIONAL

166. Foreign money orders.

(1) Foreign money orders shall be of the following categories, namely:

- (a) electronic money order; and
 - (b) Pos transfer through International Financial System or Universal Postal Union Interconnection Platform (UPU-IP).
- (2) The countries and territory with which money orders of each kind are exchanged by entering into bilateral or multilateral agreements, shall be such as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

- (3) The foreign money order agreement with partner postal countries or territories may be activated or deactivated by the Central Government.
- (4) Every foreign money order shall be booked on the payment of the amount to be remitted along with the fee for the service as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.
- (5) The operational and other general conditions for exchange of foreign money orders between two partner countries or territories shall be determined by the Central Government from time to time.
- (6) The maximum and minimum amount, and number of remittances made by a remitter through money orders in a calendar year shall be such as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

167. Advice to remitter of foreign money order.

The remitter of a foreign money order shall be entitled to receive an advice of its payment by paying a fee as may be specified by administrative instructions and such fee shall be in addition to the fee chargeable on the foreign money order.

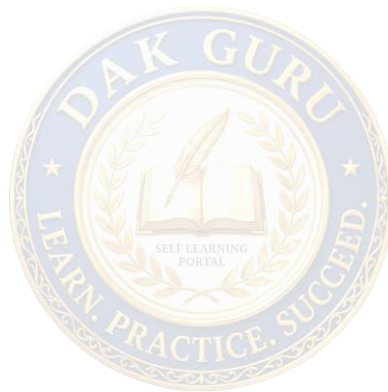
168. Remitter to change name or address for payment.

- (1) The remitter of a foreign money order may, by payment of second fee, change the name or address of the payee, until the money order is paid at the destination, as per the conditions as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.
- (2) The remitter may stop the payment of the foreign money order, if not paid, and may request that the remitted amount be returned to them as per the conditions as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.
- (3) The Post Office shall, in no case, be held liable for inability to fulfill the request of the remitter under sub-regulations (1) and (2), but, in such cases, the second fee shall be refunded.

169. Inward foreign money orders.

- (1) The payment of inward foreign money orders shall be as provided for domestic electronic money orders, except otherwise specified by administrative instructions.
- (2) A foreign inward money order, being undeliverable, shall be returned to the country or territory of origin.
- (3) A foreign outward money order, on being returned by the country or territory of destination as undeliverable, shall be returned to the remitter.

(4) In the event of inability to return the money order to the remitter, money order shall be dealt with as per the relevant provisions of regulations 154 and 155.



CHAPTER XI

BUSINESS SOLUTIONS

A. BOOK NOW PAY LATER

170. Book now pay later facility.

(1) The corporate customers, who sign an agreement with the concerned authority of a post office, shall be eligible for the credit facility in respect of postage and other fee or charges on the items, as specified by administrative instructions, under the book now pay later (BNPL) facility.

Explanation: For the purposes of this sub-regulation "corporate customer" means anyone who provides minimum business worth of postage and other fee or charges on the items, in a calendar month at a booking office at single or multiple locations, as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) The Regional Head shall be authorised to relax the limit of providing the monthly business of postage and other fee or charges, subject to such conditions as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(3) The eligibility for customers seeking book now pay later (BNPL) facility with booking at multiple locations within a circle or region shall be the monthly business comprising all the locations, as specified by administrative instructions from time to time:

Provided that, in exceptional cases, the limit in such cases may be relaxed with the approval of the Circle Head or, as the case may be, the Regional Head.

171. Authority authorised to approve.

(1) The Divisional Head shall be authorised for approving the enrolment of corporate customer under credit facility and to specify, from time to time, the designated office and designated place where the items of such customer, availing the credit facility may be booked at or addressed to in respect of all other cases falling under their jurisdiction.

(2) In case of general post office (GPO) or Class 1st head post office (HO), the powers of the Divisional Head under sub-regulation (1) may be exercised by the Director or Chief Post Master, as the case may be.

(3) The Circle Head or Regional Head of respective circle or region shall be the approving authority for cases involving customer seeking book now pay later (BNPL) facility with booking at multiple locations within a circle or region.

B. NATIONAL ACCOUNT FACILITY (NAF)

172. National account facility.

(1) The customers having requirement of posting their items from more than one circle, shall be eligible for the national account facility in respect of postage and other fee or charges on the items, as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

(2) The eligibility and process of application for enrolling the customer under the national accounting facility shall be as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

C. ADVANCE PAYMENT

173. Advance payment facility.

(1) The contractual customer, who enter into an agreement with the concerned authority of a post office, shall be eligible for availing advance payment facility in respect of postage and other fee or charges on the items, as may be specified by administrative instructions, provided that the booking data are made available to the booking office by such customer in the specified electronic format.

(2) The eligibility and process of application for enrolling the customer under advance payment shall be as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

Administrative Instructions on BNPL Discount Structure (from 2024 Regulations):

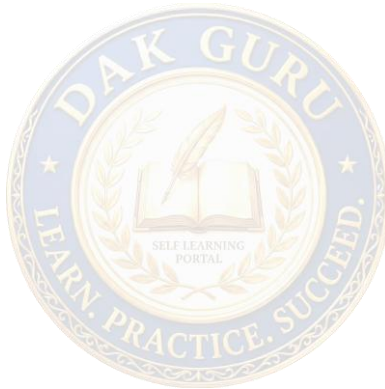
Volume Discount

The following discount structure will be available to contractual customers of Speed Post document & Parcel (domestic) and India Post Parcel:

Monthly Revenue	Speed Post Document (Domestic) & Speed Post Parcel	India Post Parcel
Rs 50,001/- to 5,00,000/-	10%	7%
Rs 5,00,001/- to 25,00,000/-	15%	10%
Rs 25,00,001/- to 100,00,000/-	20%	13%
Rs 100,00,001/- to 500,00,000/-	25%	16%
Above Rs 500,00,000/-	30%	20%

- **1% additional discount** will be offered to those contractual customers who either avail advance deposit facility or make payment at the time of booking.

- In case monthly revenue is **more than Rs. 25 lakh**, additional discount for such customers will be **2%**.
- In case of COD article, if RTS is **more than 25%** for a particular month, postage of such articles shall be excluded from the postage while calculating the discount.
- In case of non-COD article, if RTS is **more than 8%** for a particular month, postage of such articles shall be excluded from the postage while calculating the discount.



CHAPTER XII

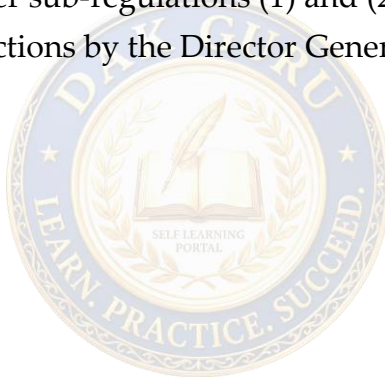
PRODUCTS AND SERVICES OFFERED THROUGH COLLABORATION

174. Post Office network for citizen centric services.

(1) Post Office shall provide its network for offering citizen centric service offered by any Ministry or Department under the Central Government in accordance with the mutually agreed terms and conditions.

(2) The concerned authority of a Post Office entering into a partnership or agreement, shall provide any product or service towards promotions or implementation of the policies of the State Government, local bodies, public or private entities, in accordance with the mutually agreed terms and conditions.

(3) The charges, operating and accounting procedures for operationalisation of these partnerships or agreement as per sub-regulations (1) and (2) above, shall be such as may be issued by administrative instructions by the Director General from time to time.



CHAPTER XIII

MISCELLANEOUS

A. PINCODE

175. Postal Index Number.

- (1) PIN Code (Postal Index Number Code) is a six-digit postcode for the particular area mapped to the post office that receives the mail items for delivery under its jurisdiction.
- (2) PIN Code shall be specified by the Director General from time to time.
- (3) The writing of PIN code shall be mandatory on each item for transmission by post.

B. REMOTELY MANAGED FRANKING MACHINE

176. Franking machines.

- (1) Franking machines (Remotely Managed) of such vendors and models, which are authorised by the Director General, shall only be used for franking an appropriate postage value on the items.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this regulation, "franking machine" means a machine authorised by the Director General, which provides an alternative mode for payment of postage in respect of an item through a unique frank impression and can be managed from a remote location through a server for uploading credits or postage value and are also called "remotely managed franking machines".

- (2) The Post Office shall not incur any liability for any damage or loss, caused to the licensee due to the purchase of an unapproved model or defective machine or any damage done to the machine.
- (3) Any person, organisation, or authority may take the license for using the franking machine for franking a postage value on the items.
- (4) The Divisional Head or independent Gazetted Postmaster of the Post Office shall be the licensing authority for issuance of license for using franking machine (RMFM) on certain fees as may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.
- (5) The licensing authority shall be authorised to issue or renew or suspend or cancel a license issued for using a franking machine.

(6) The licensing authority may reserve the right to refuse the issue or renewal of a license and cancel a license at any time after giving an opportunity being heard and for reasons to be recorded in writing.

(7) The franked mail shall only be presented in the designated post office, identified at the time of issuance of license.

(8) The mail which is franked on a particular day shall be presented in the designated post office on the same date or on the very next working day (if is not presented due to special circumstances) along with statement of mailing:

Provided that the licencing authority may relax the period of presentation of franked mail in the post office under special circumstances and for the reasons to be recorded in writing.

(9) The conditions, procedure of working, recharging and checking in respect of franking machine (RMFM), shall be as such may be specified by administrative instructions from time to time.

177. Issuance of updated version of regulations annually.

All the amendments made to these regulations may be compiled and an updated version of these regulations containing all the amendments made during a particular year, shall be published in the month of **January** of the following year.

178. Postal operations order.

(1) All the executive or administrative orders, to be specified under these regulations, shall be issued by the Department of Posts in the Government of India through orders, namely "postal operations order" or "PO order".

(2) All postal operations orders issued shall also be compiled on half yearly basis and such compilation shall be issued in the month of July and January, for the orders issued during January to June and July to December, respectively.

SCHEDULES

TABLE VII of SCHEDULE I

Price of Embossed Envelopes and Registration Envelopes

The embossed envelope and the registration envelopes specified below shall be sold at the following prices, namely:

Item	Price
Embossed Envelopes	
For each (Domestic) envelope	₹ 5/-
Registration Envelopes	
(i) For each small envelope	₹ 22/- + 50 paise stationery charges
(ii) For each large envelope	₹ 22/- + ₹ 1/- stationery charge

TABLE FOR RECOVERY OF DUES (GST Excluded)

Amount to be recovered at the time of delivery

S.No.	Mail Product	Weight (gms)	Postage	Product to be treated in Infringement of initial Product	Postage of later Product	Amount to be recovered
1	Letter	20	5	Letter	5	Not applied
2	Registered Letter	20	22	Letter	22	Not applied
3	Literature for Blind	1000	0	Letter/Parcel/Book Post	-	Not applied
4	Book Post (Ordinary)	600	37	Letter/Parcel (whichever the Postage is lower)	Parcel = 52	Deficiency: (2 x 52) - 37 = 67
5	Book Post (Regd)	600	54	"	Parcel = 52	Deficiency: (2 x 52) - 54 = 50
6	Gyan Post	300	37	India Post Parcel - Retail	IP Parcel with Regn = 53	Deficiency: 2 (53-37) = 32
7	Letter Card	5	3	Letter	5	Deficiency: 2 (5-2.5) = 5
8	Postcard	5	1	Letter	5	Deficiency: 2 (5-0.50) = 9

S.No.	Mail Product	Weight (gms)	Postage	Product to be treated in Infringement of initial Product	Postage of later Product	Amount to be recovered
9	Periodical Post (Rs.10)	100	2	Book Post	7	Deficiency: 7 - 2 = 5

179. Regulation 179: Insurance Services

- Postal Life Insurance (PLI) & Rural Postal Life Insurance (RPLI).
- This regulation empowers the Central Government or Director General to issue Administrative Instructions governing the operation of insurance services.
- It replaces the rigid structures of the old Post Office Insurance Fund Rules, allowing for more flexible, updated guidelines for PLI/RPLI products, premiums, and claims management through executive orders.

Regulation 180: Administrative Instructions for Financial Services

- Financial Services (POSB, Savings Certificates, Money Remittance, etc.).
- This regulation empowers the Central Government or Director General to issue Administrative Instructions regarding financial services provided by the Post Office.
- It covers the operational guidelines for Small Savings Schemes, Money Orders, and other banking services, enabling the Department to update interest rates, service charges, and procedural rules (like KYC or limits) swiftly via administrative orders rather than amending the act itself.

CHEAT SHEET: POST OFFICE REGULATIONS, 2024

Parent Act: Post Office Act, 2023 | **Notified:** Dec 16, 2024 | **Structure:** 15 Chapters, 180 Regulations, 5 Schedules.

I. OVERVIEW OF CHAPTERS

Chapter	Regulations	Topic Covered	Key Takeaways / Mnemonic
Ch 1	1 – 2	Preliminary	Short Title & Definitions (Accountable items, Payee, etc.).
Ch 2	3 – 40	General Rules	Business Hours (Reg 3), Power to fix hours (Reg 4), Payment of Postage, Stamps, Prohibitions, Packing.
Ch 3	41 – 72	Delivery of Items	Delivery of Accountable/Non-accountable items, Refusal, Undelivered Mail , Redirection.
Ch 4	73 – 86	Compensation	Liability of Dept, Claims process for Loss/Damage/Delay.
Ch 5	87 – 106	Domestic Items	Limits on weight/size, specific rules for Letters, Parcels, Book Packets within India.

Chapter	Regulations	Topic Covered	Key Takeaways / Mnemonic
Ch 6	107 – 127	International Items	Foreign Post rules, Customs declarations, Prohibited items abroad.
Ch 7	128	Universal Postal Service	Defines core services (Letters/Postcards/Parcels) available to <i>all</i> citizens at affordable rates.
Ch 8	129 – 131	Official Correspondence	Service Stamps, Camp Bag, Special Bags for high officials.
Ch 9	132 – 144	Value Added Services	Registration , Insurance, COD, Proof of Delivery (POD).
Ch 10	145 – 169	Money Remittance	Money Orders (eMO), IPOs, International remittances.
Ch 11	170 – 173	Business Solutions	Bulk Mail, BNPL (Book Now Pay Later), Franking Machines.
Ch 12	174	Collaborations	Partnerships with other entities (Govt/Private) for service delivery.
Ch 13	175 – 178	Miscellaneous	PIN Codes, Identity Cards, Philately rules.
Ch 14	179	Insurance Services	PLI & RPLI (Enabling provision for Admin Instructions).
Ch 15	180	Financial Services	POSB & Savings Certs (Enabling provision for Admin Instructions).

II. KEY REGULATIONS TO REMEMBER

- **Reg 3 (Business Hours):** Defines standard 6 hours for counters; Max 5 hours for BOs.
- **Reg 4:** Empowered **Circle/Regional Heads** to extend/modify business hours.
- **Reg 9:** Dealing with **Fraudulent/Used Stamps** (Defaced/Cut stamps rejected).
- **Reg 20:** Exemption on address details for **VVIP/High Officials** (Camp Bag).
- **Reg 128: Universal Postal Service** (The "Public Service" Obligation).
- **Reg 179:** Replaces old PLI Rules; empowers DG to issue orders for PLI/RPLI.
- **Reg 180:** Replaces old POSB Rules; empowers DG to issue orders for Savings Bank.

III. THE 5 SCHEDULES (FEES & RATES)

- **Schedule I:** Postage & Fees for **Domestic Items** (Letters, Parcels).
- **Schedule II:** Postage & Fees for **Other Items** (Media Post, Direct Post).
- **Schedule III:** Postage & Fees for **International Items**.
- **Schedule IV:** Charges for **Value Added Services** (Registration fee, Insurance fee).
- **Schedule V:** Charges for **Money Remittance** (MO commission).

IV. QUICK COMPARISON (Old vs. New)

- **Old:** Indian Post Office Act, 1898 & IPO Rules, 1933 (Rigid).
- **New:** PO Act, 2023 & **PO Regulations, 2024** (Flexible).
- **Shift:** Rules for PLI and Savings Bank are no longer hard-coded in the Act; they are now managed via **Administrative Instructions** (Reg 179/180) to allow faster interest rate/product changes.



PREMIUM SPEED POST PRODUCTS (2026 LAUNCH)

Issued By: Mail Operations Division, Dated 19.12.2025.

Planned launch (per SOP): January 2026. **Actual launch:** 17 March 2026, formalised by the Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (S.O. 1329(E)); tariffs since revised w.e.f. 1 August 2026 (Fifth Amendment). **Category:** Premium variants under **Speed Post**

Study Notes: Premium Speed Post Products (2026 Launch)

Authority: Mail Operations Division, Dated 19.12.2025.

Launch: SOP plan January 2026; actual launch 17 March 2026 (Second Amendment, S.O. 1329(E)); tariff revised w.e.f. 1 August 2026 (Fifth Amendment).

Category: Premium variants under Speed Post.

1. Product Overview & Scope

These products are introduced to capture the BFSI (Banking, Financial Services and Insurance) market and compete with private couriers by offering **Day Definite Delivery**.

Feature	24 SPEED POST	48 SPEED POST
Service Definition	Guaranteed delivery on Next Day (D+1) .	Guaranteed delivery in Next 2 Days (D+2) .
Availability	6 Metro Cities only: Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad.	6 Metro Cities only: Same list.
Bag Color Code	RED.	ORANGE.
Primary USP	Money Back Guarantee (Full Refund if delayed).	Money Back Guarantee (Full Refund if delayed).
Bundled Service	OTP Delivery (Free/No extra charge).	OTP Delivery (Free/No extra charge).

2. Tariff Structure (Exclusive of GST)

These rates are significantly higher than standard Speed Post due to the guarantee.

A. 24 SPEED POST (D+1) Rates

Weight Slab	Local	Up to 200 km	201 - 500 km	501 - 1000 km	1001 - 2000 km	Above 2000 km
Up to 50g	₹ 38	₹ 94	₹ 94	₹ 94	₹ 94	₹ 94
51g to 250g	₹ 48	₹ 118	₹ 126	₹ 136	₹ 144	₹ 154

Weight Slab	Local	Up to 200 km	201 - 500 km	501 - 1000 km	1001 - 2000 km	Above 2000 km
251g to 500g	₹ 56	₹ 140	₹ 150	₹ 164	₹ 172	₹ 186

B. 48 SPEED POST (D+2) — Retail Rates (Table IV C)

Correction (in force 1 August 2026): the notified table has **five** columns — “Local up to 200 km” is a **single combined slab**. (An earlier SOP draft showed a separate “Local ₹25 / ₹31 / ₹36” column; that column does **not** appear in the notified Post Office (Fifth Amendment) Regulations, 2026, and must not be used.)

Weight Slab	Local & up to 200 km	201 – 500 km	501 – 1000 km	1001 – 2000 km	Above 2000 km
Up to 50 g	61	61	61	61	61
51 g – 250 g	77	82	88	94	100
251 g – 500 g	91	98	107	112	121

C. 24 SPEED POST — Contractual Bulk Rates (Table IV E)

Weight Slab	Local	Within State	Between Metro Cities	Rest of Country
Up to 50 g	38	50	68	70
51 g – 500 g	48	60	94	100

D. 48 SPEED POST — Contractual Bulk Rates (Table IV F)

(Note: there is **no** separate “Local” column — the first slab is “Within State”.)

Weight Slab	Within State	Between Metro Cities	Rest of Country
Up to 50 g	48	56	60
51 g – 500 g	59	70	72

(All premium tariffs in ₹, GST extra. Retail = Tables IV B / IV C; Contractual bulk = Tables IV E / IV F — substituted / inserted by the Post Office (Fifth Amendment) Regulations, 2026, S.O. 4053(E) dated 23.07.2026, in force 1 August 2026.)

3. Operational Procedures (SOP Highlights)

A. Booking

- **Cut-off Time:** 4 PM for retail counters; 6 PM for Bulk/BPC with direct bagging.

- **Mandatory Fields:** Mobile Number of Sender & Addressee (crucial for SMS alerts & OTP).
- **Labeling:**
 - **24 Speed Post:** Must use **Red** Priority Sticker.
 - **48 Speed Post:** Must use **Priority Sticker** (Orange implied by bag color).

B. Processing & Transmission

- **Bagging:**
 - **24 Speed Post: Red Color Bag.** Must reach Origin APTMO/NSH by **8 PM**.
 - **48 Speed Post: Orange Color Bag.** Must reach Origin NSH by **8 PM**.
- **Air Transmission:**
 - **24 Speed Post:** Connected to flights the **same night**.
 - **48 Speed Post:** Connected to flights by **9 AM** next morning.

C. Delivery

- **Priority:** Topmost priority. Separate delivery manifest issued.
- **Method:** Delivery staff **must call** the addressee to confirm availability.
- **Update:** Real-time update on Internal Mobile App (IMA) at the doorstep.
- **OTP:** Delivery is OTP-based (Complementary service).

4. Compensation Policy (Money Back Guarantee)

This is the most critical regulatory change for these products.

- **Eligibility:**
 1. **Delay:** Full refund of Speed Post charges.
 2. **Loss/Damage/Pilferage:** Double the Speed Post charges **OR** ₹1000 (whichever is less).
- **Timeline:** Claim must be filed within **7 calendar days** from committed delivery date.
- **Resolution Time:** Claims resolved within **7 working days**.
- **Payment:** Directly to customer's bank account.
- **Exclusions:** Force majeure, incorrect address, prohibited items, or booking after cut-off time.

5. Staff Incentives (Exam Important)

To ensure priority handling, staff are incentivized per article.

Role	Incentive for "24 Speed Post"	Incentive for "48 Speed Post"
Booking PA (Retail)	₹ 3.00 per article	₹ 2.00 per article

Role	Incentive for "24 Speed Post"	Incentive for "48 Speed Post"
Booking Supervisor	₹ 0.30 per article	₹ 0.20 per article
Delivery Staff	₹ 2.00 per article	₹ 2.00 per article
Sorting PA (Hub)	₹ 0.25 per article	₹ 0.25 per article

6. Key Differences for "Match the Following" Questions

Parameter	24 SPEED POST	48 SPEED POST
Timeline	D+1 (Next Day)	D+2 (Next 2 Days)
Bag Color	RED	ORANGE
Flight Connection	Same Night (Priority)	Next Morning (By 9 AM)
Booking Incentive	₹ 3.00	₹ 2.00
Target Audience	Urgent Documents	`

